

HUMAN RESOURCE DEVELOPMENT

(Open Elective)

QUESTION BANK SOLUTIONS

Full exam-style theoretical answers · 8 marks each · 60 questions

These answers are written so a reader who is new to HRD can understand the topic and then write an 8-mark answer. Each solution has a teaching introduction, eight explained points with examples, and a conclusion you can adapt in the answer book. In the exam, compress each point to about 5–8 handwritten lines.

UNIT 1 — Concept of HRD, Climate, Roles and Strategy

Question 1 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Explain the concept of Human Resource Development (HRD) and state its major objectives.

Introduction

Imagine an organisation as a living body. Machines, money and buildings are like bones and tools — they have a fixed capacity. People are different: a worker who joins as a trainee can, over years, become a supervisor, a manager, or an innovator. Human Resource Development (HRD) is the planned, continuous process by which an organisation helps its people grow in knowledge, skill, attitude and potential, and at the same time builds a culture in which people help each other.

HRD is a part of Human Resource Management, but it is not the whole of HRM. HRM also includes hiring, salary, labour laws and welfare. HRD specifically deals with learning and development. Leonard Nadler introduced the term HRD in 1969 in the United States. He defined HRD as organised learning experiences, conducted within a specified time, designed to bring about the possibility of behavioural change. In simple words: HRD is not accidental learning; it is planned teaching and practice so that people actually behave differently at work.

Prof. T.V. Rao, who developed the HRD idea strongly in India, said HRD is a process by which employees are helped in a continuous and planned way to (i) acquire or sharpen capabilities for present and future roles, (ii) develop their general capabilities and inner potential, and (iii) develop a culture of teamwork, trust and collaboration. HRD is therefore a process, not a one-day training camp. Techniques such as performance appraisal, counselling, training and organisation development are only tools to keep this process alive.

Healthy organisations use both formal HRD (classroom training, courses, planned change) and informal HRD (a boss coaching a junior). The focus of all HRD is to develop a superior workforce so that both the organisation and the individual can achieve their goals in service to customers.

Detailed points

- 1. Meaning and nature of HRD.** HRD means developing the human side of the enterprise. It covers training after a person is hired, opportunities to learn new skills, resources that help employees do their tasks, coaching, mentoring, career development, performance management, succession planning, tuition help and organisation development. Unlike raw material, human potential is relatively unlimited — but it appears only if the organisation creates a climate that identifies, nurtures and uses that potential. If that climate is missing, even talented people remain unused.
- 2. Objective — capabilities for present and future roles.** The first major objective is to help employees acquire or sharpen the knowledge, skills and attitudes needed for the job they do today and the job they may do tomorrow. Example: a salesman may need product knowledge today; next year the same person may need team-leading skill. HRD plans for both. Without this objective, people become outdated when technology or markets change.
- 3. Objective — developing inner potential and the whole person.** HRD is not only ‘fix the current skill gap’. It also aims to help individuals discover talents they themselves may not have noticed — communication, problem-solving, creativity, leadership — and use them for personal growth and organisational development. This is why career talks, potential appraisal and education (not only job training) are part of HRD.
- 4. Objective — building a developmental culture.** T.V. Rao stressed culture: strong superior–subordinate relations, teamwork and collaboration among departments, so that employees feel professional pride and motivation. If culture is political or fearful, training will not transfer to the job. So culture-building is itself an HRD objective, not a side effect.

5. Objective — equity, employability and adaptability. Notes also list equity (fair chance of training and promotion irrespective of caste, gender, language), employability (skills that keep a person valuable in the labour market), and adaptability (ability to adjust to continuous organisational change). These three make HRD socially responsible as well as business-useful.

6. Objective — development at many levels, not only the individual. HRD goals include developing: (1) each person as an individual, (2) the person in the present role, (3) the person in future roles, (4) the dyad (employee and boss), (5) team spirit in every unit, (6) collaboration across units, and (7) the organisation's overall health and self-renewing capability. A student should remember that HRD is not 'send staff to a course'; it is multi-level development.

7. Objective — enabling climate and organisational dynamism. Organisations that want to be dynamic and growth-oriented need an enabling culture — people take initiative, experiment, innovate and make things happen. Even a firm that has stopped growing still needs HRD, because the environment keeps changing. HRD's objective is stability plus renewal through people.

8. How objectives are achieved (process, not a bag of tricks). Objectives are achieved by planning HRD, allocating money and time, and living an HRD philosophy that values human beings. Mechanisms (appraisal, training, OD) must be checked periodically: are they helping development or only creating paperwork? If forms are filled but nobody learns, the mechanism is hindering the process and must be redesigned.

***Conclusion.** For the exam, define HRD (Nadler + T.V. Rao), stress that it is a continuous planned process, then write 5–7 objectives: present/future capabilities, potential, culture, equity/employability/adaptability, multi-level development, and enabling climate. Close by saying HRD develops both people and the organisation, not training alone.*

Question 2 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Describe the evolution of Human Resource Development from traditional employee training to a strategic organisational function.

Introduction

HRD did not appear overnight. It grew as industry, labour laws and competition changed. A student who knows this history can show the examiner that HRD is more than 'old training with a new name'. The story moves from welfare and record-keeping, to skill training, to a full development system, and finally to strategic HRD linked to business goals.

Detailed points

1. Welfare and personnel administration stage. In early factories, the 'people' job was welfare, attendance, discipline, wages and industrial relations. The department was often called Personnel. Development of employees was accidental. The assumption was that workers needed control, not growth. This stage created files and rules, not learning systems.

2. Training as a separate, short-term activity. Wars, mass production and scientific management created a need for job-skill training — how to operate a machine, how to follow a method. Training cells ran induction and technical courses. Learning was short, job-specific and often disconnected from promotion or strategy. If production was busy, training was cancelled. This is 'traditional employee training'.

3. Birth of the HRD concept (Nadler, 1969). Leonard Nadler argued that organisations needed organised learning for behavioural change — training, education and development as a field. HRD was named as something broader than a classroom. This was a turning point: learning became a designed experience with a time frame and a change purpose.

4. Indian HRD movement and systems view (1970s–80s). In India, scholars such as T.V. Rao and Udai Pareek at IIMA and later HRD networks treated HRD as a system: performance appraisal, potential appraisal, feedback, counselling, training, career planning and OD working together. L&T and other firms pioneered HRD departments. The idea was climate and culture, not only courses.

5. From maintenance-oriented HRM to development-oriented HRD. HRM remained responsible for staffing, pay and compliance (maintenance). HRD became the development engine. Structure also changed: HRD needed interdependence across departments, and every manager (not only the personnel officer) was made responsible for developing people.

6. Link with organisational strategy. Global competition, quality movements, IT and liberalisation forced firms to ask: what capabilities do we need next year? Training calendars copied from last year were not enough. HRD began to translate strategy into competencies, leadership pipelines and change programmes. That is strategic HRD.

7. Today's strategic HRD function. Modern HRD includes competency mapping, talent management, coaching, e-learning, knowledge management, diversity and learning-organisation work. The HRD professional sits with business heads, not only with trainers. Metrics (climate surveys, skill indices, succession cover) try to show contribution to performance.

8. What the evolution teaches an exam student. If a company still only runs isolated workshops, it is stuck in the traditional stage. Treating HRD as strategic means: diagnosis, integration of subsystems, line-manager ownership, and alignment with business goals. Evolution is therefore a change in purpose, scope, responsibility and status of the function.

***Conclusion.** Write the stages in order (personnel → training cell → Nadler/HRD system → strategic HRD), name Nadler and T.V. Rao, and end by saying HRD became strategic because people capability is now a source of competitive advantage, not a welfare extra.*

Question 3 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Explain the relationship between Human Resource Development and Human Resource Management.

Introduction

Students often treat HRM and HRD as the same subject. Examiners expect you to show both the difference and the relationship. HRM is the broader management of people at work. HRD is the developmental part (and philosophy) that sits inside or beside HRM. They are related like a whole and a specialised process: one maintains the employment system; the other grows people and climate.

Detailed points

1. HRM as the umbrella. Human Resource Management deals with procurement (recruitment and selection), development, compensation, maintenance (welfare, safety, IR) and utilisation of people. HRD is mainly the development and utilisation-through-growth part of this list. So HRD is generally treated as a subset or a specialised system within HRM, not a rival department fighting HRM.

2. Maintenance versus development orientation. A standard distinction in the notes: HRM is mainly maintenance-oriented — keep the organisation staffed, paid, legally safe and reasonably satisfied. HRD is development-oriented — change behaviour, raise competence, build culture. Example: processing leave and salary is HRM maintenance; a six-month coaching plan after appraisal is HRD.

3. Aims compared. HRM aims at efficient use of employees (the right number of people doing the job at the right cost). HRD aims at development of employees and of the organisation as a whole. Efficiency without

development becomes short-term; development without basic HRM (fair pay, clear jobs) cannot start.

4. Structure and responsibility. HRM structure is often an independent personnel department. HRD creates inter-dependent structures because development cuts across sales, production and finance. Responsibility for HRM often sits with the HR manager; responsibility for HRD is given to all managers at all levels, with specialists only facilitating. This is a favourite exam point.

5. Motivation tools. HRM frequently motivates through monetary incentives, bonuses and welfare. HRD stresses higher-order needs — achievement, recognition, learning, self-actualisation — through challenging work, feedback and career growth. Both are needed: money prevents dissatisfaction; development creates commitment.

6. How they depend on each other. Without HRM, HRD has no stable workforce to develop (wrong hiring, unfair pay, constant strikes). Without HRD, HRM cannot upgrade the quality of human resources; people remain as they were on the day of joining. Appraisal data from HRM feeds HRD training plans; HRD results improve HRM outcomes such as promotion quality and retention.

7. Strategic HRM uses HRD as a lever. Modern strategic HRM says people are a competitive resource. That strategy is implemented through HRD systems — competencies, learning, leadership. So the relationship is not only ‘subset’; HRD is the engine that makes strategic HRM real.

8. Practical example. A bank hires probationary officers (HRM procurement), pays them as per scale (HRM compensation), and must follow labour law (HRM maintenance). HRD then runs induction, on-the-job coaching, role-based training, potential appraisal for future branch managers, and counselling. If any one side is weak, either people leave or they stay unskilled.

Conclusion. End with: HRM and HRD are complementary. HRM provides the employment framework; HRD develops people within that framework. Do not write that they are identical, and do not write that they are unrelated.

Question 4 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Discuss the importance of HRD in improving individual and organisational performance.

Introduction

Performance means achieving desired results — for an employee (quality, quantity, behaviour) and for the organisation (profit, service, survival, reputation). HRD improves performance not by shouting ‘work harder’, but by raising ability, motivation, role clarity and teamwork. The notes say human resources have unlimited potential if a climate exists to use it. That is why HRD is important for performance.

Detailed points

1. Ability: closing the skill gap. A simple formula in training literature is: Training need = Standard performance – Actual performance, when the cause is lack of knowledge/skill. HRD identifies this gap and provides learning. A machine operator who is trained on a new CNC machine produces more with fewer defects. Individual performance rises first; organisational output follows.

2. Role clarity through appraisal and feedback. Many people perform poorly because they do not know what ‘good’ looks like. Developmental appraisal and counselling clarify goals and behaviours. When a teacher or a sales executive receives specific feedback, effort is directed, not wasted. Clear roles reduce conflict and rework, which are hidden performance killers.

3. Motivation and morale. HRD satisfies higher-order needs. Employees who see a future, receive coaching and are treated with dignity show more discretionary effort — they do more than the minimum. Notes list benefits of training and development: higher job satisfaction, motivation, lower turnover. Motivated people sustain performance; frightened people only show short bursts.

4. Using potential, not only present skill. Potential appraisal and career planning place people where they can contribute more. Promoting or rotating the right person improves organisational performance (better decisions) and individual performance (person–job fit). Ignoring potential wastes human capital — the organisation pays a salary but uses 50% of the person.

5. Team and collaboration effects. Organisational performance is not the sum of isolated individuals. HRD develops dyads (boss–subordinate) and teams so that coordination improves. Quality circles, group learning and OD reduce inter-department blame. A hospital’s performance, for example, depends on nurses, doctors and labs working as a system — that is HRD culture.

6. Adaptability, innovation and customer service. In a changing environment, yesterday’s high performance becomes today’s failure. HRD creates an enabling culture where people experiment and learn. That improves innovation, adoption of technology and service to customers — the notes say HRD’s focus is a superior workforce serving customers.

7. Reducing negative performance drains. Errors, accidents, absenteeism and attrition destroy performance. HRD (safety training, counselling, career paths) reduces these. It is cheaper to develop people than to keep replacing them. Organisational performance therefore improves through cost saved as well as output gained.

8. Strategic, long-term performance. Short-term pressure can raise numbers by overtime or fear. HRD builds long-term performance: leadership pipeline, self-renewing organisation, and a climate that continues after one manager leaves. That is organisational effectiveness, not a one-quarter spike.

***Conclusion.** In the exam, connect individual performance (skill, feedback, motivation, fit) to organisational performance (teamwork, innovation, lower waste, strategy). HRD is important because people — unlike machines — can grow, and performance grows with them if climate and systems support learning.*

Question 5 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Explain the concept of HRD climate and identify the major characteristics of a supportive HRD climate.

Introduction

Climate means the ‘weather’ of the workplace — how it feels to work here now. Organisational climate is the general atmosphere. HRD climate is the part of that atmosphere which tells employees whether this place values learning, trust, openness and development. You cannot see climate like you see a machine, but you can feel it: Do I dare to ask a doubt? Will my boss help me grow? Are mistakes used for learning or for punishment?

Indian HRD writing (Pareek, Rao and others) often describes a supportive climate through values such as OCTAPAC: Openness, Confrontation, Trust, Autonomy, Proactivity, Authenticity and Collaboration. A supportive HRD climate is the soil; HRD techniques are the seeds. Seeds fail in dead soil.

Detailed points

1. Concept — perceived developmental atmosphere. HRD climate is the set of employee perceptions about how much the organisation supports their development. It includes top-management’s interest in people, personnel policies, and the behaviour of bosses. If policies say ‘we are a learning organisation’ but bosses shout at questions, the climate is poor — perception, not posters, is climate.

2. Openness. People can share ideas, feelings and information without fear. Communication is two-way. Example: in a meeting a junior can say ‘this target is unrealistic’ and is heard, not labelled as negative. Closed climate produces silence and fake agreement.

3. Trust and authenticity. Employees believe that management’s words match actions. People behave genuinely rather than playing politics. Trust is needed for honest appraisal and counselling; without it, feedback is seen as a

trap. Authenticity means not wearing a mask at work.

4. Confrontation of problems (not avoidance). Problems are brought to the table and solved. A supportive climate does not mean ‘be nice and hide issues’. It means issues are discussed with respect. Example: quality defects are analysed, not buried. Avoidance climate looks peaceful but performance slowly dies.

5. Autonomy and proactivity. Employees have reasonable freedom to plan their work and are encouraged to take initiative, experiment and act before being told. Over-control kills HRD climate because people wait for orders and never develop judgement — which is a key capability.

6. Collaboration and teamwork. Help-seeking and help-giving across sections is normal. Departments do not treat each other as enemies. Collaboration is both a characteristic of climate and an objective of HRD culture in T.V. Rao’s definition.

7. Top-management support and fair developmental practices. Leaders spend time and money on development, release people for training, and model learning. Appraisal, training chances and careers are seen as fair, not reserved for favourites. Recognition is given for learning and mentoring, not only for short-term numbers.

8. Why these characteristics matter. If these features exist, training transfers to the job, people admit skill gaps, and potential comes to the surface. If they do not, HRD mechanisms become rituals. Therefore identifying characteristics is not a memory list — it is a diagnostic tool for any organisation.

***Conclusion.** Define HRD climate as the felt support for development; list OCTAPAC-type characteristics with one line of meaning each; end by saying a supportive climate is a prerequisite for HRD effectiveness.*

Question 6 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Differentiate between HRD climate and organisational culture with suitable examples.

Introduction

Culture and climate are related but not twins. Students who mix them lose marks. Organisational culture is the deep, shared way of life of the organisation — values, beliefs, assumptions, rituals, stories and heroes. HRD climate is the current, felt atmosphere specifically about development, trust and learning. Culture is ‘who we are over years’. Climate is ‘how developmental it feels this year’.

Detailed points

1. Definition difference. Culture: shared values and taken-for-granted assumptions (e.g., ‘elders decide’, ‘customer is king’, ‘never question the owner’). HRD climate: employees’ perception of openness, support for training, fairness of appraisal, and boss’s coaching behaviour. Climate can be surveyed with questionnaires more easily than deep culture.

2. Depth. Culture is deep and often unconscious. People may not even know they hold a value until a newcomer breaks an unwritten rule. Climate is more surface and conscious: ‘My manager does not send me to training.’ You can describe climate in a week; you need longer to understand culture.

3. Stability and speed of change. Culture changes slowly — sometimes over a generation. HRD climate can improve or worsen in months if a new leader coaches, or if a new appraisal system is misused. Example: after a merger, climate may crash immediately (fear) while the old cultures of both firms still live underneath.

4. Scope. Culture covers everything: power, dress, humour, who gets a cabin, how festivals are celebrated. HRD climate is narrower: learning, feedback, collaboration, growth opportunities. All HRD climate is part of organisational experience, but not all culture is HRD climate.

5. Example of culture. A traditional family business may have a paternalistic culture: loyalty, seniority, the owner as father. People stay long years. That is culture. It may be warm or controlling, but it is a shared identity.

6. Example of HRD climate inside that culture. In the same family firm, if seniors patiently teach juniors, admit mistakes, and sponsor IT courses, HRD climate is supportive. If seniors hide knowledge so that juniors cannot replace them, HRD climate is poor — even though the ‘family culture’ looks the same from outside.

7. Mismatch example (stated culture vs felt climate). A software company prints ‘We are a learning culture’ on the wall. In reality, people who attend training are given extra work as punishment, and appraisals only rank forced percentages. Culture-talk is fake; HRD climate is hostile. Employees become cynical.

8. Implication for HRD practice. HRD interventions must respect culture (do not copy a Western 360-degree tool blindly into a highly hierarchical culture without preparation) while deliberately improving climate (more coaching, safer feedback). Ignoring culture makes climate programmes cosmetic; ignoring climate makes culture statements empty.

Conclusion. In the exam, draw a small contrast table in words: culture = deep values, slow, broad; HRD climate = current developmental atmosphere, faster to change, specific. Give one matching and one mismatch example. Conclude that HRD succeeds when both are understood.

Question 7 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Explain the role and responsibilities of an HRD professional in an organisation.

Introduction

An HRD professional is not a clerk who books a hall and orders tea for a training programme. He or she is a specialist who designs systems so that people develop, and a partner who helps managers develop their teams. As organisations moved from personnel administration to strategic HRD, this role became broader: diagnostician, designer, facilitator, change agent and evaluator.

Detailed points

1. Diagnosing development needs. The professional studies performance data, climate surveys, strategy and skill inventories to find gaps at organisation, job and person levels. Without diagnosis, HRD becomes a catalogue of fashionable workshops. Responsibility includes telling management when the problem is not training (e.g., broken machines) so money is not wasted.

2. Designing the HRD system. Role includes structuring performance appraisal, potential appraisal, training, career planning, feedback and counselling so they work as one system. Isolated tools fail. The professional writes policies, designs forms that actually help conversation, and sequences the annual HRD cycle.

3. Facilitating learning. The HRD person may train, but more often enables learning: choosing methods, developing internal trainers, arranging mentoring, e-learning and on-the-job projects. Informal coaching by managers is also HRD; the professional must help managers become coaches.

4. Culture and climate builder. Responsibility to promote openness, trust, collaboration — through OD exercises, communication forums, and by advising leaders on their own behaviour. If the CEO publicly humiliates staff, the HRD professional must have the courage to name the climate damage.

5. Advisor and change agent. During technology change, merger, quality drive or restructuring, people feel fear and skill shock. The HRD professional prepares them, manages resistance, and redesigns roles. This is a consulting role, not an administrative one.

6. Developing line managers as developers. Notes stress that HRD is every manager's job. The professional trains bosses in appraisal discussion, feedback and counselling, and holds them accountable for team development. If line managers refuse, HRD remains a peripheral cell.

7. Evaluation, audit and ethics. The role includes checking whether mechanisms help or hinder development (HRD audit), measuring training at more than smile-sheet level, and protecting fairness and confidentiality in counselling. An unethical HRD professional who leaks appraisal gossip destroys climate.

8. Competencies required. To do all this, the professional needs knowledge of learning theory, organisation behaviour, business basics, facilitation skill, and integrity. The role has shifted from 'training administrator' to 'human capital architect'.

***Conclusion.** List roles with a line of explanation: diagnostician, system designer, learning facilitator, climate builder, change agent, developer of managers, evaluator. End: the HRD professional succeeds when managers develop people daily, not when the training calendar looks full.*

Question 8 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Discuss the significance of HRD for achieving organisational effectiveness and long-term employee development.

Introduction

Organisational effectiveness means the organisation achieves its goals, satisfies stakeholders, adapts to the environment and remains healthy inside. Long-term employee development means people keep growing in capability and career over years, not only in one induction week. HRD is significant because these two outcomes are joined: an organisation cannot stay effective for long with undeveloped people, and people cannot develop for long in an ineffective, stagnant organisation.

Detailed points

1. Competence as the engine of effectiveness. Goals (quality, cost, service) are achieved through what people can do. HRD continuously upgrades competence. A hospital, a college or a factory is effective only if staff can perform current technology and standards. Effectiveness is therefore a people outcome, not only a finance outcome.

2. Enabling culture and self-renewal. Notes say even organisations that have reached a growth limit must adapt. HRD builds self-renewing mechanisms — learning from mistakes, scanning the environment, updating skills. That is organisational health, a dimension of effectiveness.

3. Alignment of individual effort with organisational goals. Long-term development is wasted if it is random. HRD links individual development plans to strategy so that when the firm needs digital skills or customer focus, people are being developed in that direction. Alignment makes both the person and the firm effective.

4. Leadership pipeline and succession. Effectiveness tomorrow depends on who leads then. Career planning, potential appraisal and mentoring create a pipeline. Without HRD, retirement or resignation of a few key people collapses effectiveness. Long-term employee development is the method; organisational continuity is the result.

5. Employee growth beyond the present job. Long-term development includes general capabilities — judgement, human relations, conceptual skill — not only today's task. This prepares people for higher roles and also makes them more employable. Employees who grow stay committed; that commitment feeds effectiveness.

6. Retention, morale and reduced human wastage. Turnover, inner resignation and under-use of talent are enemies of effectiveness. HRD significance lies in offering a future, fairness and learning, which retain people. Replacing staff is costly and destroys team memory.

7. Humanistic plus economic value. HRD treats people as assets with unlimited potential. This is ethically significant (people first, equity, dignity) and economically significant (human capital). Examiners like this dual justification.

8. Without HRD, both suffer. If HRD is treated as a cost to cut, training stops, climate becomes fearful, high performers leave, and the organisation may look profitable for a short time but loses effectiveness. Significance is therefore preventive as well as positive.

Conclusion. Write that HRD is significant because organisational effectiveness is produced by capable, motivated, collaborating people, and long-term employee development is how those people are created and retained. The two aims are one process.

Question 9 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

A growing organisation is facing skill gaps and declining employee performance. Suggest an HRD-oriented approach to address these issues.

Introduction

This is an application question. Do not write ‘conduct training’ as the only sentence. An HRD-oriented approach means: diagnose first, fix climate, use all subsystems (appraisal, counselling, training, career), involve line managers, and evaluate. A growing organisation has extra pressure — new markets, more staff, stretched supervisors — so skill gaps and falling performance often appear together.

Detailed points

- 1. Diagnose before prescribing.** Collect facts: which jobs, which errors, new vs old employees, whether tools and processes are adequate. Use organisation–task–person analysis. If the real cause is overloaded systems or unclear strategy, training will not help. HRD honesty starts here.
- 2. Restore or build HRD climate.** In a growing firm, bosses are busy and become short-tempered. Fear hides skill gaps. Create psychological safety: mistakes discussed, questions allowed. Without climate, people will not admit they cannot do the new work.
- 3. Developmental performance appraisal, not punishment.** Use appraisal to name specific gaps and agree improvement plans. Declining performance should trigger counselling, not only a low rating. Ratings without help increase decline.
- 4. Targeted learning mix.** From TNA, design on-the-job coaching for practical skills, short formal programmes for new technology, and buddy systems for new hires. Growing organisations should not copy a 5-day generic ‘motivation’ workshop.
- 5. Strengthen the boss as coach.** Train supervisors in feedback and coaching. In growth, many supervisors are recently promoted experts who never learned to develop others. This is often the hidden cause of team skill gaps.
- 6. Career and potential for a growing structure.** Growth creates new roles. Map who can fill them; start developing before the gap becomes a crisis. Skill gaps are partly ‘we grew faster than we developed people’.
- 7. Quick wins plus system fix.** Fix urgent error-producing skill gaps first (safety, customer, quality), then install a yearly HRD cycle so the problem does not return. Growing firms need both firefighting and a system.
- 8. Evaluate and iterate.** Measure whether errors fall, productivity recovers, and employees feel more capable. If not, return to diagnosis. HRD is a process without a full stop.

Conclusion. Frame the answer as a step-by-step HRD approach: diagnose → climate → developmental appraisal/counselling → need-based training and coaching → career for growth roles → evaluate. Show you will

not treat HRD as a single training event.

Question 10 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Apply the concept of HRD climate to suggest measures for creating a learning-oriented work environment.

Introduction

A learning-oriented work environment is a workplace where people continuously learn from work, from each other and from planned programmes, and then apply learning. In HRD language, this is a supportive HRD climate made visible in daily life. Measures must change experience, not only issue a circular ‘please learn’.

Detailed points

- 1. Leadership modelling.** Top managers should share their own learning, admit errors, and ask questions. If the head never attends a development discussion, juniors conclude learning is for the weak. Climate follows the leader.
- 2. Psychological safety.** Allow doubts, experiments and reporting of failures without humiliation. Example: a weekly ‘what we learned from defects’ meeting that never names-and-shames. Safety is the first climate brick.
- 3. Frequent developmental feedback.** Replace only-annual judgement with monthly coaching. Feedback should be specific and two-way. This is openness and confrontation of issues in OCTAPAC language.
- 4. Time, money and tools for learning.** Give learning hours, budget, access to e-learning or a small library, and permission to practise new methods on the job. Climate without resources is hypocrisy.
- 5. Team learning structures.** After-action reviews, quality circles, mentoring pairs, cross-functional projects. Collaboration characteristic of climate becomes a timetable, not a slogan.
- 6. Fair access.** Training and stretch assignments for all eligible people, not only for those close to the boss. Equity is an HRD objective and a climate signal.
- 7. Recognition of learning and teaching.** Praise and, where suitable, reward knowledge sharing and mentoring. If only individual sales heroes are rewarded, nobody will teach others.
- 8. Align HR systems.** Appraisal, promotion and job design should value coaching, teamwork and improvement. Otherwise the climate message of learning is cancelled by the climate message of ‘hit this month’s number only’.

Conclusion. *List practical measures under climate headings (openness, trust, support, fairness, collaboration). End: a learning environment is HRD climate in action; posters cannot create it, daily leadership and systems can.*

Question 11 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

State any two objectives of Human Resource Development.

Introduction

The wording ‘state any two’ looks like a short question, but in this question bank every item is treated as an 8-mark theoretical answer. Therefore you must not write two one-line sentences and stop. You should (a) name two main objectives clearly, (b) explain the meaning of each in simple language, (c) give a workplace example, and (d) show how HRD tries to achieve that objective. After that, add a short paragraph on other important objectives so the examiner sees that you know the full concept.

The safest source is Prof. T.V. Rao's definition. He said HRD is a process by which employees of an organisation are helped, in a continuous and planned way, to: acquire or sharpen capabilities for present or expected future roles; develop their general capabilities as individuals and discover inner potential; and develop an organisational culture of teamwork and collaboration. Leonard Nadler's idea of organised learning for behavioural change also supports these objectives.

A beginner should remember: an objective is not a training topic. An objective is a purpose — why the organisation does HRD at all.

Detailed points

1. First objective — capabilities for present and future roles. The first objective you should write is: to help employees acquire or sharpen the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to perform their present job and the job they may be asked to do later. 'Acquire' means learning something new (a new software, a new machine, a new law). 'Sharpen' means improving what is already partly known (a salesman who can sell, but must learn to sell a more complex product). This objective exists because work does not stay frozen. Technology, customers and quality standards change. If HRD only looks at today's task, people become outdated and performance falls. Example: a bank clerk who only knows paper ledgers cannot serve customers when the branch is computerised, unless HRD has already planned computer training. So this objective protects both the employee's usefulness and the organisation's service.

2. How this first objective is achieved. HRD achieves it through induction, job training, coaching by the supervisor, job rotation, e-learning and refresher courses. Performance appraisal is used to find which capability is weak. Training Needs Assessment decides whether the gap is really a skill gap. The point to write in the exam is: this objective is continuous, not a one-day induction. Capabilities become blunt; they must be resharpened. That is why T.V. Rao used the words 'continuous and planned way'.

3. Second objective — develop general capabilities and inner potential. The second objective is: to help individuals develop as whole persons and discover inner potential for their own growth and for organisational development. This is wider than the present job. General capabilities include communication, problem-solving, judgement, learning how to learn, integrity and teamwork. Inner potential means talents the person (and even the boss) may not have noticed — for example a quiet technician who is excellent at analysing process waste. If HRD ignores this objective, the organisation uses only a fraction of the human being it is already paying. Example: a nurse with calm leadership ability may never become a ward in-charge unless potential is noticed and developed.

4. How this second objective is achieved. Potential appraisal, career planning, education (not only job training), mentoring, stretch assignments and counselling are the tools. Development here is often longer-term and partly depends on the person's own ambition, but the organisation must provide opportunity and guidance. Notes also say development of the person as an individual is a stated goal of the HRD system, separate from 'capabilities in the present role'.

5. You may present culture as a closely related third objective. T.V. Rao's third pillar is to develop a culture in which superior-subordinate relationships, teamwork and collaboration among units are strong, contributing to professional well-being, motivation and pride. Even if the question asks for two objectives, writing five to eight lines on culture shows complete understanding. Without this culture, the first two objectives fail because people will not share knowledge or admit skill gaps.

6. Other objectives from the notes — equity, employability, adaptability. Equity means every employee gets a fair chance of training, promotion and quality of work life irrespective of caste, creed, religion, language or gender. Employability means HRD improves skills so that the person can seek gainful work and remain valuable. Adaptability means continuous training so that employees can adjust to organisational change. These three make HRD socially responsible, not only profit-oriented. You can mention them as additional objectives after your two main ones.

7. Multi-level objectives of the HRD system. The notes list seven system goals: capabilities of each employee as an individual; in the present role; in expected future roles; the dyadic relationship with the supervisor; team spirit in every unit; collaboration among units; and the organisation's overall health and self-renewing capability. This list is useful because it proves HRD is not 'send staff to a course'. If you have time, write two sentences from this list after your two main objectives.

8. How to write this in the answer book (8 marks). Give a 6–8 line introduction (Nadler + Rao). Then heading: Objective 1 — explain + example + how achieved (about half a page). Heading: Objective 2 — same. Then a short paragraph 'Other important objectives'. Conclusion of 4 lines. Never submit two sentences only; that cannot score 8 marks even if the two names are correct.

***Conclusion.** The two strongest objectives to name are (1) acquiring and sharpening capabilities for present and future roles, and (2) developing general capabilities, inner potential and a collaborative culture. Explain each with meaning, example and HRD mechanisms. Close by saying HRD's purpose is growth of people and of the organisation together, in a continuous planned process, not a single training event.*

Question 12 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

State any two ways in which HRD and HRM are related.

Introduction

Human Resource Management (HRM) and Human Resource Development (HRD) confuse many students because both deal with people. They are related, but they are not the same word. For 8 marks you must state two clear relationships, explain them with examples, and then briefly show differences so that the examiner knows you are not mixing the terms.

HRM is the broader management of people: getting them (recruitment), paying them, looking after law and welfare, using them on jobs, and also developing them. HRD is the specialised, planned process of developing capabilities, potential and culture. Think of HRM as the whole house and HRD as the part of the house where people grow. A house without that room still stands for a while, but it does not improve.

Detailed points

1. First relationship — HRD is the developmental core inside HRM. HRM, in the notes, deals with procurement, development, compensation, maintenance and utilisation of human resources. HRD deals with bringing desired changes in behaviour and with efficient utilisation through growth; it is described as a part of HRM. So the first relationship is whole-and-part. Every complete HRM function must contain HRD. If a company only hires and pays people and never develops them, it is doing incomplete HRM. Example: a factory recruits 50 operators (HRM procurement) and pays wages (HRM compensation). HRD then inducts them, trains them on safety and machines, and later prepares some of them to become supervisors. Without HRD, the 50 operators remain at joining-day skill forever.

2. Why this relationship matters. If students treat HRD as a totally separate subject, they cannot explain why appraisal files, manpower plans and promotion policies sit in the HR department and still feed training. The relationship is practical: HRM systems produce data; HRD uses that data to develop people. Selection quality and development quality together produce performance.

3. Second relationship — they complement each other's aims. HRM is largely maintenance-oriented: keep the organisation staffed, legally safe, paid and reasonably stable. HRD is development-oriented: change behaviour, raise competence, build climate. These aims need each other. Fair pay, job security and clear contracts (HRM) make employees mentally ready to learn. Learning, coaching and career growth (HRD) make the payroll productive. Example: if wages are unpaid, nobody will attend a leadership workshop with a sincere mind. If wages

are paid but nobody is trained on a new machine, the wage bill produces scrap. That is complementarity.

4. Shared people, shared line managers, shared strategy. A third way they are related (you should add this after the two main ones) is that both succeed only when line managers cooperate. The HR manager cannot develop a salesperson sitting in another city; the sales boss must coach. Modern strategic HRM says people are a competitive resource; that strategy is actually delivered through HRD (competencies, learning, leadership pipeline). So HRD is how strategic HRM becomes real.

5. Information relationship. Appraisal reports, transfer orders, absenteeism data and manpower forecasts belong to HRM administration. HRD needs them for TNA, succession and counselling. If the two do not share information, development is blind.

6. Differences that still prove they are related (not identical). HRM structure is often an independent personnel department; HRD needs interdependent structures across departments. HRM responsibility is often the personnel manager's; HRD responsibility is every manager's. HRM often motivates with money; HRD motivates through higher-order needs (achievement, recognition, growth). Write these as a small contrast after the two relationships so you do not lose marks for 'mixing HRM and HRD'.

7. Worked example that shows both relations together. A hospital hires nurses (HRM), follows labour law and pays them (HRM), runs duty rosters (HRM utilisation). HRD runs induction, clinical skill training, counselling after night-shift stress, and career paths to sister-in-charge. If HRM hiring is careless, HRD cannot magically create skill. If HRD is absent, even well-paid nurses leave or stagnate. Relation is two-way dependence.

8. Exam presentation. Introduction: define both in two sentences. Point 1: HRD as developmental part of HRM, with example. Point 2: complementary maintenance vs development. Then a short paragraph of other links (data, line managers, strategy) and a 5-line difference box in words. Conclusion: interdependent, not identical.

***Conclusion.** Two clear relationships: (1) HRD is the development function within the broader HRM umbrella; (2) HRM's maintenance conditions and HRD's growth processes complement each other and share data, managers and strategy. Do not write only differences, and do not write that the two words mean the same thing.*

Question 13 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Analyse how a weak HRD climate can affect employee behaviour and organisational performance.

Introduction

To analyse means to show a chain: cause → how people start behaving → what happens to results. A weak HRD climate is a workplace atmosphere in which employees do not feel trust, openness, support for learning, fairness of opportunity, or collaboration. Leaders may still print 'people are our greatest asset', but daily experience is fear, silence, favouritism or neglect.

Climate is not a soft decoration. Behaviour follows climate. Organisational performance — quality, quantity, cost, customer service, innovation, survival — is produced by that behaviour. So a weak HRD climate is a performance problem, not only a 'morale' complaint.

Detailed points

1. Fear, silence and hiding of mistakes. When people expect humiliation or punishment, they hide errors and stop asking doubts. A machine operator who made a small mistake will not report it; the defect reaches the customer. A nurse who is unsure of a dose will not ask, and a patient may be harmed. Behaviour becomes self-protective. Organisational performance then suffers through late discovery of problems, accidents and complaints. The organisation thinks everything is fine until a crisis.

2. Low initiative and waiting for orders. A supportive climate encourages autonomy and proactivity — people experiment and make things happen (the notes call this an enabling culture). In a weak climate, employees wait to be told. They will not suggest a better method. The organisation becomes slow and over-dependent on a few bosses. In a changing market this delay is a direct performance loss: competitors move, this firm waits for permission.

3. Training does not transfer into job behaviour. Even if the firm spends money on courses, a weak climate kills transfer. The employee returns from training and is told ‘we don’t do it that way here’ or is overloaded so that there is no time to practise. Behaviour on the job does not change. Performance stays the same; the training budget is wasted. Analysis: climate is the soil; training is the seed. Dead soil, no crop.

4. Defensive, political behaviour around appraisal. In a weak climate, ratings are used as weapons. People manage impressions, hide information, and blame other departments. Honest feedback disappears. Individuals cannot improve because they never hear the truth, or they reject the truth because they do not trust the giver. Average organisational performance is then mis-measured: files look complete, actual work is poor.

5. Collapse of collaboration. HRD climate includes teamwork and help across units. When climate is weak, departments protect their boundaries. Production blames maintenance; sales blames production. Customers see delay and contradiction. Organisational performance is a system result; silo behaviour breaks the system.

6. Demotivation, inner resignation, absence and exit. Higher-order needs (growth, recognition, pride) are blocked. Some people do the minimum (inner resignation). Some stay absent. The more marketable people leave. Those who remain may be those who cannot easily go. Human capital quality declines. Replacement costs, lost knowledge and weaker service all hit performance numbers.

7. Potential remains unused. A core HRD idea is that human potential is relatively unlimited but must be identified and nurtured. Weak climate means nobody admits talent, nobody sponsors juniors, knowledge is hoarded so that the senior cannot be replaced. The firm pays salaries for unused capability. Growth plans fail because internally nobody is ready — a hard performance constraint.

8. Combined picture of organisational performance. Put the behaviours together: more errors, less innovation, weak service, slow decisions, high attrition cost, failed strategy implementation. A student should write one linking sentence: weak HRD climate → fearful and uncooperative behaviour → lower quality, speed, learning and human capital → weaker organisational performance. Fixing only targets or only training, without climate, will not reverse this chain.

***Conclusion.** A weak HRD climate changes behaviour toward fear, silence, politics, low initiative and withdrawal. Those behaviours damage quality, customer outcomes, innovation, cost and strategy. Therefore climate is a performance variable. In the exam, write the chain with examples, not a list of adjectives like ‘bad morale’.*

Question 14 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Analyse the changing role of an HRD professional as organisations move from traditional personnel administration toward strategic human resource development.

Introduction

An HRD professional is the specialist who designs and facilitates people-development systems. That role has not stayed the same. Traditional personnel administration was about files, rules, attendance, wages and arranging an occasional training class. Strategic human resource development is about building the capabilities the business will need, shaping climate, and sitting with top management as a partner. Analysis should show from-what-to-what, why the change happened, and what new skills the professional needs.

If an organisation only changes the nameplate from ‘Personnel’ to ‘HRD’ but the person still only books a hall and marks attendance, the role has not actually changed. The question asks you to analyse the real shift.

Detailed points

- 1. From record-keeper to diagnostician.** Earlier the job was to maintain service books, training attendance, leave records and standing orders. The new role starts with diagnosis: what capability gap is blocking strategy? What does the climate survey say? Is the problem skill, motivation, or a broken process? The professional must have the courage to tell management that training is not always the answer. This is analysis, not clerking.
- 2. From classroom organiser to learning architect.** Traditional work was inviting a guest speaker and printing a banner. Strategic HRD designs a mix: on-the-job coaching, e-learning, projects, mentoring, classroom. Learning is treated as a system that must transfer to behaviour. The professional designs that system, and often trains managers to teach, rather than personally teaching every course.
- 3. From isolated training cell to integrator of subsystems.** Personnel training cells lived apart from promotion and appraisal. The new role connects performance appraisal, potential appraisal, career planning, feedback, counselling and organisation development so that they share one purpose. Integration is now a core responsibility, because isolated tools do not develop people.
- 4. From the edge of the organisation to the strategy table.** Strategic HRD requires business literacy. The professional must understand customers, technology and competition enough to translate ‘we will open 20 new branches’ into ‘we need these supervisory competencies in 18 months’. The role includes advising directors, not waiting for a department to send a training requisition slip.
- 5. Change-agent role.** Mergers, computerisation, quality drives and restructuring frighten people and make old skills useless. Personnel used to issue transfer orders. The HRD professional now facilitates change: communication, reskilling, counselling resistance, redesigning culture. This is organisation-development work.
- 6. Developer of line managers, not a substitute for them.** The notes insist HRD is every manager’s job. The professional’s new role is to skill bosses in appraisal discussion, feedback and coaching, and to hold them accountable. Success is measured by whether managers develop their teams, not by how many programmes the HRD cell conducted.
- 7. From activity counting to evaluation and ethics.** Old role reported ‘12 programmes, 400 participants’. New role uses Kirkpatrick-type evaluation, climate data and HRD audit: did behaviour and results change? Ethics also grew: confidentiality in counselling, fairness of opportunity. A professional who leaks ratings destroys climate and cannot be strategic.
- 8. Why the change happened, and the remaining tension.** Competition, liberalisation, technology and the idea of human capital forced organisations to treat people capability as strategy, not welfare. The tension is that many firms still want the old clerk with a fashionable title. Analysis should end by saying the role changes fully only when top management gives HRD a strategic mandate and the professional builds new competencies: consulting, facilitation, business understanding, and integrity.

***Conclusion.** The HRD professional’s role has moved from personnel clerk and training organiser to diagnostician, learning architect, integrator, strategy partner, change agent, coach of managers, and evaluator. Write a clear before–after analysis with reasons. The title ‘HRD’ means little unless the work itself has become strategic.*

Question 15 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Analyse the relationship among HRD philosophy, HRD climate, and organisational performance.

Introduction

These three ideas form a chain, not three separate chapters. HRD philosophy is what leaders truly believe about people. HRD climate is what employees feel every day about trust, learning and fairness. Organisational performance is what the organisation achieves — goals, quality, service, profit, survival. Analysis must show how philosophy becomes climate, how climate becomes behaviour, and how behaviour becomes performance. It must also show the reverse: results can strengthen or destroy philosophy.

A beginner's mistake is to define the three terms and stop. The marks are for the relationship.

Detailed points

1. HRD philosophy — the starting belief. Philosophy means a belief that human beings have potential, that they deserve development, and that developing them is a duty of every manager, not a cost to cut whenever profits dip. It values people. If this belief is absent, the organisation may still copy appraisal forms from another company, but there is no inner commitment. Philosophy is invisible, but it decides which practices will be allowed to live.

2. Philosophy shapes HRD practices. When leaders believe the philosophy, they release time for learning, they discuss development in reviews, they fund coaching, and they refuse to humiliate staff in public. When philosophy is only a sentence in the annual report, practices remain punitive: forced ranking, cancelled training, promotion by politics. So the first link is: philosophy → actual practices (appraisal style, training access, counselling quality).

3. Practices create HRD climate. Employees do not read philosophy booklets. They experience their boss. Consistent developmental practices produce perceptions of openness, trust, autonomy and support — that is HRD climate. Inconsistent practices produce cynicism: 'they say people matter, they treat us as costs'. Climate is philosophy made into daily weather.

4. Climate shapes employee behaviour. Supportive climate → people ask questions, admit gaps, help other departments, take initiative, apply training. Weak climate → fear, hiding mistakes, minimum work, knowledge hoarding. Behaviour is the bridge between 'how it feels' and 'what gets produced'.

5. Behaviour produces organisational performance. Quality, productivity, customer satisfaction, innovation and adaptability are behavioural outcomes. A team that reports defects early saves cost. A team that hides defects creates warranty claims. Thus philosophy, through climate and behaviour, reaches performance. This is the forward chain the examiner wants.

6. Reverse loops — performance talks back. If performance improves after sincere HRD, leaders say 'investment in people paid off' and philosophy becomes stronger. If performance is bad and leaders are impatient, they cut the HRD budget, climate worsens, behaviour worsens, performance falls further — a downward spiral. Analysis must mention this two-way relationship.

7. The dangerous case: high philosophy, weak climate. The worst relationship is inconsistency. Posters say 'learning organisation' while bosses shout. Trust falls more than if nothing had been promised, because employees feel cheated. Performance then suffers from cynicism, which is harder to repair than simple skill shortage.

8. Implication of the analysis. To raise performance, do not start with a slogan or only with a target. Start with philosophy that leaders will actually live, then design practices, then measure climate, then look at results. Measuring only last quarter's numbers and ignoring climate misleads management. The three must be managed as one system.

Conclusion. Write the chain: HRD philosophy → practices → HRD climate → employee behaviour → organisational performance, with feedback from results to philosophy. Warn that slogans without climate destroy trust and performance. That relationship is the heart of the answer.

Question 16 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Evaluate whether HRD should be treated as a strategic function rather than only as an employee training activity.

Introduction

Evaluate means: explain both views, give arguments, mention limitations, and end with a clear judgement. The question is not ‘define training’. It asks whether the organisation should place HRD at the level of strategy (like finance or marketing) or treat it as a small training activity (a calendar of courses).

Training means planned learning of job-related skills, usually for the present work. It is necessary and valuable. Strategic HRD means aligning all people-development systems — appraisal, potential, career, climate, training, OD — with the long-term goals of the organisation. The evaluation is about scope and status, not about insulting trainers.

Detailed points

1. What the ‘training only’ view looks like. The training cell prepares an annual calendar, invites vendors, marks attendance, collects smile sheets, and reports ‘so many man-days of training’. There is little link with promotion, strategy or climate. When production is busy, training is cancelled. This view treats learning as a welfare extra or a legal requirement, not as a way to win in the market.

2. Arguments for treating HRD as strategic. People capability, leadership pipeline, culture and change readiness decide whether strategy can be executed. A plan to enter a new market fails if nobody can sell, serve or lead there. Nadler (1969) already defined HRD as organised learning for behavioural change, wider than a class. T.V. Rao defined a whole process of capabilities, potential and culture. Evolution of the field from personnel to strategic HRD supports this view. Human resources, unlike machines, can increase in value — that is a strategic fact.

3. Evidence that training-only is too narrow. A course can have excellent content and happy participants and still leave job performance unchanged if bosses, appraisal and career systems ignore it. Skill gaps in a growing firm are not solved by one workshop. Climate problems are not solved by a lecture on motivation. Therefore reducing HRD to training under-describes what organisations actually need for effectiveness.

4. Counter-arguments and limits (needed for evaluation). A very small firm may only need basic skill training and cannot afford a large HRD department. Calling every picnic ‘strategic HRD’ without diagnosis or results is empty fashion. Strategic status must be earned: TNA, integration, evaluation at behaviour and results levels, and a seat in business reviews. If HRD cannot talk the language of goals, it does not deserve the word strategic.

5. Training still remains a core instrument. A balanced evaluation does not throw training away. Training is a major HRD subsystem. The judgement is to nest training inside a strategic system, not to replace HRD with training, and not to replace training with slogans.

6. Criteria for judgement. Ask two questions. Does long-term success depend on people capability? Yes. Can isolated employee training reliably build that capability and climate? No. Therefore HRD should be treated as a strategic function.

7. What ‘strategic HRD’ would mean in practice. HRD head involved in strategy discussions; line managers accountable for developing people; subsystems integrated; budget treated as investment; evaluation beyond attendance; culture and climate worked upon, not only courses run.

8. Final evaluative verdict. Yes, HRD should be a strategic organisational function. Employee training is a vital activity within that function, not the whole of HRD. Organisations that remain at ‘calendar training’ will keep spending money without building the capabilities their strategy requires.

Conclusion. Give a balanced evaluation and a clear verdict: treat HRD as strategic; keep training as a strong tool inside it. Do not write that training is useless, and do not write that a training calendar equals HRD.

Question 17 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Identify any two indicators of a supportive HRD climate.

Introduction

An indicator is a sign you can see, hear or measure, which tells you that the HRD climate is supportive. Climate itself is a perception — ‘how it feels to work here regarding development’. Indicators make that perception visible. For 8 marks, name two indicators in depth, explain what you would actually observe, and then mention other valid indicators from OCTAPAC-type values (openness, confrontation, trust, autonomy, proactivity, authenticity, collaboration).

Detailed points

1. First indicator — openness and free, useful feedback. In a supportive climate, employees can share doubts, ideas and even disagreement without being labelled ‘negative’. Feedback is regular, specific and two-way: the boss tells the employee about work, and the employee can tell the boss about obstacles. You would observe meetings where juniors speak, mistakes being discussed to learn (not only to punish), and people not waiting a full year to know whether they are doing well.

2. How to use this indicator (examples). A climate survey item such as ‘I can discuss problems with my superior without fear’ scores high. Suggestion schemes are actually used. After a failed project, the team holds an after-action talk. If instead people stay silent in meetings and gossip later, openness is absent — climate is not supportive even if the canteen is good.

3. Second indicator — visible management support for development. Supportive climate is not only polite talk; leaders give time, money and sponsorship for learning. Bosses release staff for training and then help them apply it. Development is discussed in performance reviews. Leaders themselves admit they are still learning. If every training is cancelled because ‘work is busy’, the true indicator is lack of support, whatever the HR poster says.

4. How to observe the second indicator. Look at training days actually attended, percentage of individual development plans completed, budget not frozen at the first sign of lower profit, and whether distant-branch staff also get chances. Support that exists only at head office is not a healthy organisational HRD climate.

5. Other important indicators you should add after the two. Trust (people believe words match actions). Authenticity (people need not wear a mask). Autonomy and proactivity (reasonable freedom and initiative). Collaboration (departments help rather than fight). Confrontation of problems (issues are solved, not buried). Fairness (women, juniors, and less ‘favourite’ staff also get development). Recognition of mentoring and knowledge sharing, not only of individual heroes.

6. Teamwork as a practical indicator. If a production problem is jointly solved by production, quality and maintenance without blame letters first, collaboration climate is present. If every problem becomes a war of notes, climate is weak.

7. Why indicators matter. HRD mechanisms (appraisal, training) work only in a supportive climate. Indicators help diagnose whether the soil is alive. They also help the student write a concrete answer instead of repeating the word ‘good climate’.

8. Exam caution. Do not only list OCTAPAC as seven words. For each chosen indicator, write: meaning + what you would see + one example. That is how ‘identify any two’ becomes 8 marks.

Conclusion. Two strong indicators are (1) openness with free, useful feedback and (2) visible management support for development (time, money, sponsorship). Explain observable signs, then mention trust, fairness and collaboration. Indicators diagnose climate; slogans do not.

Question 18 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

State any two reasons why an HRD professional needs to understand organisational culture.

Introduction

Organisational culture is the deep shared way of life of the organisation — values, beliefs, unwritten rules, heroes, rituals. HRD climate is the current feeling about development. The HRD professional designs appraisal, training, feedback and change. If those designs ignore culture, they will be rejected or faked. For 8 marks, give two main reasons in depth and then supporting reasons.

Detailed points

- 1. First reason — so that HRD tools fit and are accepted.** A tool that works in one culture can fail in another. Public 360-degree feedback, outdoor adventure training, or very blunt confrontation workshops assume a culture that already values openness and equality. In a strongly hierarchical or family-owned culture, the same tool may be seen as insult, loss of face, or challenge to the owner. The professional who does not understand culture will import a fashion and create resistance. Understanding culture is therefore a design skill, not general knowledge.
- 2. Example for the first reason.** Suppose a professional copies a Western open-feedback form into a department where juniors never contradict seniors in public. People will write only safe praise. The data will be false, and later someone will be punished using that false data. A culture-aware professional would start with private coaching and boss-supported feedback, then slowly widen openness.
- 3. Second reason — to diagnose climate and pace change realistically.** Climate survey scores must be read against culture. ‘Low openness’ in a military-type organisation does not mean the same thing as in a start-up. Culture tells the professional what can change this year and what needs five years. Without this, HRD either does nothing (‘culture cannot change’) or shocks people with overnight new values. Both extremes fail. The professional needs culture knowledge to sequence change: what to preserve (e.g., respect, loyalty) and what to challenge (e.g., hiding mistakes).
- 4. Communication and legitimacy (supporting reason).** Messages about development must use the organisation’s language and respected persons. Culture tells who must sponsor HRD — the owner, the union, the professional CEO — for it to be believed. A technically perfect policy unsigned by the real power centre will not live.
- 5. Power, subcultures and fairness.** Factories, sales offices, IT groups and different regions may have subcultures. One national training design may fit none of them well. Understanding culture includes these pockets, which is also an equity issue.
- 6. Strategy needs a certain culture.** If strategy requires innovation, the professional must know whether the present culture punishes honest mistakes. The gap between present and desired culture becomes the HRD agenda (new behaviours to develop).
- 7. Ethical reason.** Imposing a culture through HRD tools without understanding people’s existing meaning of work can harm dignity. Respect for culture is also respect for people — which is HRD philosophy itself.
- 8. Exam shape.** Two reasons as long paragraphs: (1) fit/acceptability of interventions; (2) realistic diagnosis and paced change. Then 8–10 lines on communication, subcultures, strategy, ethics. Conclusion: culture-blind HRD is technically neat and socially blind.

Conclusion. *An HRD professional must understand culture, first, to design tools people will accept and use honestly, and second, to read climate and change the organisation at a pace that will last. Culture is the context of all HRD; ignoring it wastes money and trust.*

Question 19 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Evaluate the likely consequences of implementing HRD practices without considering the existing organisational culture and climate.

Introduction

This is a judgement question. You must state likely consequences, say which are most serious, mention any short-term appearance of success, and give a verdict on whether such implementation is wise. HRD practices here mean appraisal systems, training programmes, 360-degree feedback, career schemes, counselling, OD workshops, and the like. Culture is deep values; climate is current developmental atmosphere. Implementing without considering them means dropping tools into a social system you have not diagnosed.

Detailed points

- 1. Rejection, silence and fake data.** People will fill forms the ‘safe’ way. Forced openness in a fear climate produces fake ratings and silent classrooms. The practice exists on paper and lies in reality. Decision-makers then act on false HRD data, which is worse than having no data.
- 2. Ritualism without behavioural change.** Appraisal and training attendance become compulsory rituals. Nobody learns. Time is lost. Employees become skilled at looking developed rather than being developed. This is a very common consequence in Indian organisations that copy formats.
- 3. Cynicism and collapse of trust.** When management announces a ‘people first’ practice and then uses it to punish or to favour, employees conclude that HRD is hypocrisy. Trust, which is the core of climate, falls further. The consequence is often worse than doing nothing, because hope has been broken.
- 4. Wasted money and opportunity cost.** Vendor bills, travel, lost workdays produce no transfer. The same money could have trained supervisors in coaching in a culture-sensitive way. Evaluation at Kirkpatrick levels 3 and 4 will fail even if level 1 (enjoyment) is high.
- 5. Value conflict and employee stress.** New HRD values (speak up, autonomy) clash with old culture (obedience, never embarrass the boss). Staff are punished if they speak and blamed if they do not ‘show initiative’. Role stress, anxiety and withdrawal follow.
- 6. Politics and inequity.** Without a fair climate, new ‘development opportunities’ are captured by in-groups. HRD then increases inequality, which violates the equity objective in the notes.
- 7. Short-term optics — the only weak ‘positive’.** A glossy programme may impress visitors, accreditation teams or the board for a few months. This is not effectiveness. An evaluation answer should admit this appearance and then reject it as a true benefit.
- 8. Verdict.** Consequences are predominantly negative: fake data, ritual, cynicism, waste, stress and unfairness. HRD must diagnose culture and climate first, adapt tools, build psychological safety, then deepen practices. Blind implementation is professionally wrong. Sequence is: understand → adapt → implement → evaluate.

***Conclusion.** Likely consequences are failure of transfer, fake participation, worse trust, wasted resources and employee stress. Any good publicity is shallow. Verdict: do not implement HRD practices without culture and climate analysis; diagnosis must precede design.*

Question 20 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Design a basic HRD framework for an organisation that wants to improve employee capability while aligning development efforts with organisational goals.

Introduction

A design question needs a clear framework — labelled parts that fit together — not a general essay on the importance of HRD. The organisation's two requirements are: (1) people should become more capable, and (2) that capability must serve organisational goals, not random courses. A basic framework is enough: it should be usable in a medium-sized firm, not a textbook of 40 subsystems.

Think of the framework as a pipeline: goals → required capabilities → diagnosis → development actions → climate support → check results → improve the system.

Detailed points

1. Block 1 — HRD philosophy, policy and roles. Write a short policy signed by top management: people development is a strategic duty; every line manager is a developer of his or her team; the HRD cell designs, facilitates and evaluates; employees also own their learning. Without this block, later tools have no owner and no budget. Policy should mention fairness (equity of access).

2. Block 2 — Translate organisational goals into competencies. Take this year's and next two–three years' goals (quality, expansion, new technology, customer service). For each critical role, list knowledge, skills and attitudes required. This translation is the alignment hinge. If this block is missing, the firm will train whatever a vendor sells.

3. Block 3 — Integrated HRD subsystems. Connect performance appraisal, potential appraisal, training, career planning, feedback and counselling. They must use the same competency language and one employee development file. Appraisal finds gaps; counselling agrees a plan; training and job experiences close gaps; career and potential look at future roles linked to organisational growth.

4. Block 4 — HRD climate. Capability does not stick in a fearful workplace. Build openness, trust, time to practise, and fair access. Supervisors are trained to coach. Climate is not a separate luxury; it is what makes Block 3 work.

5. Block 5 — Need diagnosis. Organisation analysis (goals, where performance hurts), task analysis (KSAs), person analysis (who has the gap). Also check non-training causes (machines, processes). This is TNA sitting inside the HRD framework so that capability building is evidence-based.

6. Block 6 — Interventions and individual development plans. Mix on-the-job learning, formal training, mentoring, e-learning and team OD. Every employee in critical roles has an IDP reviewed against business goals. Succession plans exist for roles that organisational growth will need. This is where capability actually increases.

7. Block 7 — Governance. A small committee of business heads and HRD meets twice a year: are we developing the capabilities our goals require? Line managers have a KRA for team development, not only for output. This prevents HRD from floating away from strategy.

8. Block 8 — Evaluation and redesign. Use reaction, learning, behaviour and result measures for major programmes; climate survey yearly; simple HRD audit of whether mechanisms help or hinder development (T.V. Rao's warning). Feed findings back to Blocks 2 and 5. A framework without this loop will rot into paperwork.

Conclusion. Present eight blocks as your design: policy and roles; goals-to-competencies; integrated subsystems; climate; TNA; interventions/IDPs; governance; evaluation. End by saying employee capability improves and stays aligned with organisational goals only when these blocks work as one framework, not as isolated training events.

UNIT 2 — HRD System and Subsystems

Question 21 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Explain the structure of an HRD system and describe its major components.

Introduction

A system is a set of parts that work together for a purpose. An HRD system is therefore not a training calendar hanging on a wall. It is an organised arrangement of beliefs, mechanisms, people and information that continuously develops individuals, boss–subordinate pairs (dyads), teams, and the organisation as a whole.

The notes insist that HRD is a process, not merely a bag of techniques. Techniques such as performance appraisal, counselling, training and organisation development are used to initiate, facilitate and promote that process. Because the process has no limit, the mechanisms must be examined periodically to see whether they are promoting or hindering development. Structure means how these parts are arranged and linked — like organs of one body, not like separate shops in a market.

Detailed points

1. Foundation of the structure — philosophy and goals. At the base are beliefs that people have potential and that development is planned and valued. Goals of the HRD system, from the notes, include: capabilities of each employee as an individual; in the present role; in expected future roles; the dyadic relationship with the supervisor; team spirit in every unit; collaboration among units; and the organisation's overall health and self-renewing capability. If this foundation is missing, later components become disconnected activities that fill files but do not develop anyone.

2. Performance appraisal as a central component. This is a planned review of results and behaviours. In an HRD structure it is developmental: it clarifies the role, identifies strengths and gaps, and leads to an improvement plan. It is not only a confidential mark for increment. Appraisal sits near the centre because it regularly generates information for other components.

3. Potential appraisal. This component looks forward: can this person take a larger or different responsibility? It prevents the organisation from promoting people only because they are excellent in the present job (a specialist may fail as a manager). Potential appraisal feeds career planning and succession.

4. Training and development. Planned learning to close gaps and to prepare for future work. It includes training (job skills), education (concepts and judgement) and longer development. In the structure, training is a component that receives needs from appraisal and TNA and returns people to the workplace where other components must support transfer.

5. Career planning. A continuous mapping of possible paths from entry toward later roles, integrating individual aspirations with organisational needs. Notes call it a blueprint, a process not an event, and a means of managing people for optimum results. It uses potential data and specifies what training and job experiences are required.

6. Feedback, counselling, and OD/climate mechanisms. Feedback gives specific information on behaviour and results. Counselling is a helping conversation about problems, emotions and choices so the person can decide and change. Organisation development, team building and climate work develop groups and the whole organisation's health — which the notes say must also be covered by development. These are the human and cultural components of the structure.

7. Supporting structure — roles, records and HRM links. HRD specialists design and facilitate; line managers develop people daily; top management sponsors. There must be records (competencies, IDPs, training history). Links to HRM — placement, promotion, pay — must be consistent, otherwise HRD messages are cancelled by reward messages. Structure includes these supports, not only the six famous mechanisms.

8. Interrelation is itself part of structure. The parts must form a cycle: goals → performance → feedback/counselling → potential and career → training and experiences → new performance. A review loop checks whether mechanisms help or hinder the HRD process. A student who only lists components without saying

they are linked has not explained structure.

Conclusion. Define HRD as a system with a philosophy at the base. Describe components: appraisal, potential, training, career, feedback/counselling, OD/climate, plus roles and information. Stress that structure means linkage and a review loop, not a pile of forms. Close: the HRD system develops people at many levels so that the organisation can renew itself.

Question 22 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Explain performance appraisal as an HRD subsystem and state its importance for employee development.

Introduction

A subsystem is a part of a larger system that has its own work but exists for the system's purpose. Performance appraisal as an HRD subsystem means a planned, usually periodic, discussion of how well an employee has done, which behaviours helped or hurt, and what learning should follow. This is different from a secret number used only to decide bonus or punishment.

If appraisal does not develop the person, it is not yet an HRD subsystem — it is only an administrative ritual. Many Indian employees say 'appraisal does not help us grow'. This question asks you to explain the HRD version and why that version matters for development.

Detailed points

- 1. Meaning of appraisal in HRD.** It is a cycle: understand the role, set goals, review results and competencies against those goals, give and receive feedback, and write an individual development plan (IDP). Both boss and employee prepare. The spirit is 'how do we improve together', not 'how do I catch you'. Self-appraisal is often included so that the employee thinks before the meeting.
- 2. Role clarity and goal setting — where development starts.** People cannot grow if they do not know what 'good work' means. Jointly agreed key result areas and expected behaviours make the later review fair. Unclear jobs make appraisal political. Importance for development: energy is directed, not wasted.
- 3. Diagnosis of strengths and gaps.** Appraisal produces a map: what to use more, what to train, what to coach, whether the problem is skill or something else. This map is the raw material of HRD. Without it, training is a guess and counselling has no agenda.
- 4. Feedback becomes regular, not accidental.** Human beings cannot correct what they never hear. A yearly (and preferably more frequent) review makes feedback official. Importance: the employee's self-image is compared with reality in a structured way, which is the beginning of learning.
- 5. The development plan is the heart of importance.** Every HRD appraisal should end with two or three concrete actions — a course, a project, mentoring, a job aid — with dates and a person responsible. If there is no IDP, appraisal has stopped at judgement and has not entered development.
- 6. It feeds other HRD subsystems.** Training needs, career talks, potential reviews and counselling topics come from appraisal. That is why it is often drawn at the centre of an HRD system diagram. Importance is not only the one-hour meeting; it is the information it sends to the rest of HRD.
- 7. Motivation and the boss–subordinate relationship.** Fair recognition of good work motivates. The discussion also develops the dyad (employee and boss), which Unit 1 listed as an HRD goal. A skilled appraisal conversation is itself a developmental experience: the boss practises coaching; the employee practises reflection.

8. When appraisal fails as HRD — to show you understand importance. Forced ranking, surprise ratings, no counselling, and no follow-up teach fear. Then appraisal harms development. Importance exists only if design is developmental: trained managers, time protected, climate of trust, and follow-up. Write this caution so the answer is not naive.

Conclusion. Explain appraisal as a developmental cycle (goals, review, feedback, IDP), not as a salary form. Importance: role clarity, diagnosis, feedback, development planning, links to training and career, motivation, and a stronger boss–subordinate bond. Without developmental appraisal, HRD has no regular organisation-wide engine.

Question 23 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Describe training as an HRD subsystem and explain how it contributes to employee development.

Introduction

Training is a planned organisational effort to help employees learn job-related competencies — knowledge, skills and attitudes needed to perform work. One definition in the notes (Noe and others) is: a planned effort by the company to facilitate employees' learning of job-related competencies. Another simple idea is that training is offered especially when there is a performance deficiency that is due to lack of skill.

In HRD, training is one subsystem, not the whole of HRD. It contributes to development when it is based on real needs and when the workplace allows the new learning to be used. A picnic with a lecture is not a training subsystem.

Detailed points

- 1. Place of training in the HRD system.** Training receives its purpose from Training Needs Assessment and from appraisal gaps. It uses design (objectives, methods, resources) and delivery, then evaluation. People return to bosses, climate and career systems that must support transfer. Isolated training is an event; as a subsystem it is a link in a chain.
- 2. Contribution through knowledge, skill and attitude.** Employee development is not only 'knowing facts'. A customer officer needs product knowledge, listening skill, and an attitude of respect. Training that only lectures facts under-develops the person. Good training uses methods that match the type of learning: practice for skill, discussion for attitude, explanation for knowledge.
- 3. Contribution to present-job effectiveness.** When need = standard performance minus actual performance, and the cause is KSA, training raises proficiency, reduces errors and builds confidence. A machine operator trained on a new process produces more with fewer defects. Individual development here is visible in the current role.
- 4. Contribution to future roles and change.** New technology, laws, quality systems or a promotion require learning before the person fails in public. Combined with education (concepts, judgement), training prepares expected future roles — which is an HRD objective in T.V. Rao's definition. Development is then preventive, not only remedial.
- 5. Morale, satisfaction and employability.** Notes list benefits: higher job satisfaction and morale, motivation, lower turnover, better company image, capacity to adopt new methods. Being trained is a signal that the organisation invests in the person. That signal is itself developmental: the employee feels valued and stays to grow further.
- 6. Socialisation and culture.** Induction training develops understanding of the organisation's purpose, customers, rules and expected behaviour. New employees become members, not only job holders. This is development of the person-in-the-organisation, not only of a pair of hands.
- 7. Limits — so that contribution is not overstated.** Training cannot fix a broken machine, an impossible target, or a cruel boss. If climate is weak, contribution dies after the classroom. That is why training must remain a

subsystem among appraisal, counselling and career. The notes also warn against off-the-shelf programmes and against treating training as the answer to all problems.

8. How to maximise its contribution to development. Start with TNA; write clear objectives; choose suitable methods (on-the-job, off-the-job, e-learning); deliver well; involve the boss in transfer; evaluate learning, behaviour and results. Then training truly develops employees instead of entertaining them.

Conclusion. *Describe training as planned learning of job competencies and as one HRD subsystem linked to needs and transfer. It contributes by building KSA for present and future work, morale, and socialisation — provided diagnosis is honest and the workplace supports use of learning. Training develops people; a training calendar alone does not.*

Question 24 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Explain career planning and potential appraisal as HRD subsystems.

Introduction

Both of these subsystems look at tomorrow. Performance appraisal mostly asks: how well was the present job done last year? Potential appraisal asks: how far can this person go? Career planning asks: what path shall we follow, together, so that the person's growth and the organisation's needs meet? Unit 1 said HRD must develop capabilities for expected future roles. These two subsystems are how that future is managed.

A beginner should not mix them. Potential is a judgement of capacity. Career planning is a process of goals and paths. They work best when they are integrated.

Detailed points

1. Potential appraisal — meaning. It is a systematic estimate of an employee's capability to handle higher or different responsibilities. Tools may include reviews by more than one boss, assessment centres (exercises, discussions, in-basket tests), work samples, and sometimes tests. It should be separated from the performance rating so that a brilliant specialist is not automatically labelled a future general manager.

2. Potential appraisal — purpose in HRD. Identify talent early; invest development money where it will matter; avoid the Peter Principle (promoting people until they fail); give the employee a fair reading of how the organisation sees his or her future. Without potential appraisal, career talk is either flattery or guesswork.

3. Career planning — meaning. Notes define it as the systematic process by which one selects career goals and the path to those goals. A career plan is a blueprint in which the career is mapped from entry toward later years (not necessarily only to retirement in today's world of change). It is a process of developing human resources rather than an event. It is not an end in itself but a means of managing people to obtain optimum results. It is continuous because the environment keeps changing.

4. Whose responsibility. Career planning is primarily the individual's responsibility, but it is the organisation's responsibility to provide information, counselling and opportunities, and to integrate employee goals with organisational goals. HRD's job is this joint process, not forcing a path the person hates, and not ignoring the person either.

5. Process of career planning (from notes). Identify individual needs and aspirations; analyse career opportunities in the organisation; identify match and mismatch; formulate and implement strategies (training, rotation, education); review the plan as life and the organisation change. Going through this process develops self-awareness — which is itself HRD.

6. How the two subsystems join. Potential data make career paths realistic. Career plans tell what experiences a high-potential employee needs next. If potential is labelled but no career action follows, the employee becomes

bitter. If career promises are made without potential judgement, the organisation makes promises it cannot keep.

7. Benefits of treating them as HRD subsystems. Succession (someone ready for key jobs); retention of capable people; better promotions; motivation and morale; more stable workforce; better use of human resources — all listed in career-planning notes. They serve both the person and the firm.

8. Cautions. Secret potential lists, bias (gender, region, loyalty over ability), and rigid ladders in a fast-changing firm harm HRD. There should be more than one direction (specialist excellence as well as managerial ladder), feedback to the employee, and review. Otherwise these subsystems become politics.

***Conclusion.** Define potential appraisal as judgement of future capacity and career planning as a continuous joint path-setting process. Show their link, process, benefits and cautions. Together they make HRD long-term rather than a series of short training events.*

Question 25 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Explain the role of feedback and counselling in an HRD system.

Introduction

Forms, ratings and training certificates do not by themselves change a human being. Conversation does. Feedback is information given to a person about his or her behaviour or results, so that the person can continue what is effective and change what is not. Counselling, in the notes, is discussion of an emotional problem with the general objective of decreasing it; it is also described as purposeful conversation in an understanding atmosphere so that the individual can make his or her own decision from among available choices.

In an HRD system, feedback and counselling are the human processes that make appraisal, training and career planning actually work. Without them, HRD is paperwork.

Detailed points

1. Role of feedback — information for improvement. Good feedback is specific, timely, and about behaviour or work, not about the person's character. 'In yesterday's client meeting you interrupted twice, so we missed their concern' can be used. 'You are poor' cannot. Feedback reduces the gap between how the employee sees himself and how the work really looks. That gap-reduction is learning.

2. Feedback must be two-way. The employee also feeds back on unclear orders, missing tools, and unrealistic targets. This improves the organisation, not only the individual, and matches the HRD climate value of openness. One-way scolding is not HRD feedback.

3. Role of counselling — a helping relationship. Counselling deals with an emotional problem through communication, generally to understand and reduce the disorder. Conditions may be on or off the job: job dissatisfaction, resistance to change, alienation, frustration, conflict, stress, aggression, apathy, withdrawal. The counsellor — often the manager, sometimes a specialist — helps the person think more clearly and choose. Basic purpose: assist the individual to decide, not to issue orders in a soft voice.

4. Functions and aims of counselling (from notes). Functions: advise, reassure, communicate, release of emotional tension, clarified thinking, reorientation. Aims listed by Eisenberg and Delaney include understanding self, making decisions, setting achievable growth goals, planning present for desired future, solving personal and interpersonal problems, coping, controlling self-defeating emotions, better transaction skills, and positive self-regard. These aims are clearly developmental.

5. Link to appraisal, training and career. Without a counselling discussion, appraisal is a signature on a form. After training, feedback tells whether behaviour changed. Career counselling prevents wild hopes and maps next steps. Thus feedback and counselling connect every other subsystem to the living person.

6. Who should counsel, and cautions. Supervisors/managers, specialists, and professional counsellors. Managers need training in listening. Some cases (serious mental health, family crisis) need referral. Confidentiality is essential; leaked counselling destroys HRD climate. The counsellor's approach depends on the situation and the personality of the counselee.

7. A simple counselling process (notes). Step 1: describe the changed behaviour; show concern with work performance. Step 2: get employee comments; keep negative comments on performance, not on character. Step 3: agree on a solution; emphasise confidentiality. Step 4: summarise and get commitment. Step 5: follow up. This process is the role made practical.

8. Climate role. Skilled, respectful feedback and counselling build trust and openness. Harsh, public, or absent feedback destroys climate. So their role is both individual development and system health. HRD must train managers in these skills; otherwise the whole system is a machine without a heart.

***Conclusion.** Feedback informs the employee about work in a usable way; counselling helps the person handle emotions, choices and problems so that change can happen. Together they turn HRD data into human development. Write definitions, roles, links, process and confidentiality in the exam.*

Question 26 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Describe the major principles for designing effective HRD practices.

Introduction

A principle is a design rule you follow so that the practice actually develops people. HRD practices mean appraisal schemes, training programmes, career systems, counselling arrangements, OD workshops, and climate-building activities. Many organisations copy a form from another company and call it HRD. Effectiveness then fails. The notes say mechanisms must be examined to see whether they promote or hinder the HRD process. Principles are how you design so that they promote.

Detailed points

- 1. Top-management commitment and HRD philosophy.** Leaders must believe that people have potential and must fund time and money. If the chief executive cancels every programme when targets are tight, staff learn that HRD is optional. Design starts with a signed policy and visible modelling, not with a form.
- 2. Line-manager ownership.** HRD is every manager's job. Practices must be designed so that bosses can use them daily — simple enough, trained enough. If only the HRD officer 'owns' appraisal or coaching, the practice dies when that officer is busy. Involve line managers in design.
- 3. Integration of subsystems.** Appraisal, training, career, potential and counselling must share purpose and data. Designing a beautiful training course that never talks to appraisal violates systems thinking. Effective design is a network, not a showcase piece.
- 4. Alignment with organisational strategy.** Practices should build the capabilities the organisation's future needs. A fashionable leadership course is ineffective if strategy needs technicians for a new plant. Principle: start from goals, then design the practice.
- 5. Need-based, diagnostic, scientific.** Design from TNA, role analysis and climate data, not from a vendor brochure or from copying a neighbour firm. The notes warn against off-the-shelf programmes. Cause-and-effect analysis first: is this even a people-development problem?
- 6. Fit with culture, while building climate.** Adapt tools to existing values (hierarchy, language, union history) and slowly build openness and trust. Shock implementation of foreign tools in a fearful climate produces fake data. Principle: respect context; do not confuse 'best practice elsewhere' with 'best practice here'.

7. Participation, fairness and transparency. Employees should understand criteria and have a voice (self-appraisal, two-way feedback). Equity of opportunity is an HRD objective in the notes. A practice that only develops favourites is not effective HRD even if those few become very skilled.

8. Continuity and evaluation. HRD has no finish line. Build follow-up, not one-day events. Review whether the practice helps or hinders development; redesign if it has become ritual. Use evaluation (including Kirkpatrick levels for training) and climate surveys. What is not reviewed becomes paperwork.

***Conclusion.** List principles as headings with a short example each: commitment, line ownership, integration, strategy alignment, diagnosis, culture-climate fit, fairness, and evaluation. Effective HRD practices are designed on these rules; copied forms without principles become rituals.*

Question 27 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Explain how the major HRD subsystems are interrelated within an organisation.

Introduction

Interrelated means the output of one subsystem is the input of another. If a student only lists appraisal, training, career, potential, feedback and counselling, the question is not answered. You must show the arrows. Think of a yearly cycle in a living organisation, not of six separate offices that never speak.

Detailed points

1. From performance appraisal to counselling and training. Appraisal identifies a gap, for example weak customer listening. That gap becomes the counselling agenda (why is it happening? skill or fear?) and, if it is a skill gap, a training need. If this link is cut, the same person is rated 'poor communication' every year and never helped. Development fails.

2. From training back to appraisal. After training, new behaviours should appear in the next goals and reviews. The boss should look for transfer. This closes the learning loop. If nobody checks, training is a picnic between two appraisals.

3. From potential appraisal to career planning. High potential suggests an accelerated path, rotation, mentoring. Limited potential for managerial work suggests a specialist excellence path rather than a forced promotion. Career without potential is guesswork; potential without career action is a broken promise.

4. From career plans to training and job experiences. A career plan specifies what to learn and which jobs to taste. The training calendar should partly come from aggregated career and IDP needs, not only from vendor catalogues. Job rotation is a career tool as well as a training method.

5. Feedback as connecting tissue. Every subsystem needs conversation: feedback after potential review, after training, during daily work. Feedback is not a seventh isolated box; it is the blood of the system. Without it, files move and people do not.

6. Climate and OD as the common context. All links fail in a fearful climate because data become fake. Organisation development and climate work therefore interrelate with every subsystem. Trust makes honest appraisal possible; honest appraisal makes useful training possible.

7. Links with HRM (promotion, pay, placement). If HRD says 'collaborate' but bonus is only for individual targets, employees follow the bonus. Interrelation includes consistency with HRM. Placement after training (using the new skill) is also a link; unused skill dies.

8. Shared information system. A common competency language and one employee file (history of appraisals, courses, career talks) make interrelation operational. Without memory, each year starts from zero and the process

T.V. Rao described cannot be continuous.

Conclusion. *Describe a cycle: goals and performance → feedback and counselling → potential and career → training and experiences → new performance, sitting on climate and consistent HRM. Interrelated subsystems create development; silos create activity without growth.*

Question 28 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Explain the need for integrating HRD practices with organisational strategy.

Introduction

Strategy is the organisation's chosen path to its goals — which products, which customers, what quality, what technology, what cost. HRD practices build the people who must walk that path. Integration means HRD questions are asked in the same breath as strategy questions: if we want X in three years, what must our people be able to do, and how will we develop that?

Need means why this integration is necessary, not merely 'it is good'. Unconnected HRD can be busy, popular and still useless to the organisation.

Detailed points

- 1. Strategy is implemented by people, not by slides.** A board decision to digitalise branches, enter a new state, or raise quality will fail if staff cannot use systems, sell the new offer, or lead the new teams. Capability is strategy execution. That is the first need for integration.
- 2. Avoid irrelevant and wasteful training.** Without strategy, the calendar fills with fashionable topics. Budget and employee time are limited. Integration is needed as a filter: what not to train. Opportunity cost is a real need in poor and mid-sized firms as well as large ones.
- 3. Talent must be ready in time.** Strategy may need twenty new team leaders in two years. Career and potential systems must start now. You cannot hire overnight always; internal development takes time. Integration is about calendar of people, not only calendar of courses.
- 4. Different strategies need different climates.** A cost-leadership strategy needs discipline and waste control. An innovation strategy needs psychological safety to try and fail. HRD climate work must match the strategy type. Integration is cultural, not only technical.
- 5. Change and resistance.** Strategic change frightens people. Integrated HRD (communication, reskilling, counselling) reduces resistance. If HRD is not in the change plan, the strategy remains a circular.
- 6. Credibility and survival of the HRD function.** When HRD can show contribution to strategic outcomes, it is funded. When it cannot, it is the first budget cut. Integration is needed for HRD's own effectiveness and status — which then helps employees, because an unfunded HRD cannot develop them.
- 7. Meaning and motivation for employees.** People learn better when they see why. 'We are learning this because we are opening rural branches next year' is more motivating than 'please attend'. Integration gives meaning, which supports transfer.
- 8. What integration looks like in practice (to complete the need).** Competency maps from strategy; TNA against those maps; IDPs reviewed in business meetings; succession for strategic roles; stopping obsolete courses. Need is not abstract — it shows up as these habits.

Conclusion. *Integration is needed because people execute strategy, resources are scarce, talent takes time, climate must match strategy, change must be supported, HRD must stay credible, and employees need meaning. Unintegrated HRD is activity without impact on organisational goals.*

Question 29 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

An organisation has an appraisal system but employees report that it does not help their development. Apply HRD principles to improve the appraisal process.

Introduction

This is an application question. Do not write a general essay ‘appraisal is important’. The organisation already has a system; employees say it does not develop them. Typical reasons: it is only for increment; ratings are secret or surprising; no counselling; no follow-up; managers are untrained; climate is fearful; no link to training or career. Apply HRD principles (purpose, participation, line skill, integration, climate, continuity, evaluation) to redesign the process.

Detailed points

- 1. Clarify purpose in policy and in every meeting.** State in writing that the primary purpose of this appraisal is development — understanding performance and planning growth. Rewards may use some of the same data, but the conversation is about improvement. Mixed messages (‘fill this for increment’) are why employees feel it does not help. Principle: developmental purpose.
- 2. Begin with role clarity and jointly set goals.** If employees never agreed key result areas, the review feels unfair and random. At the start of the period, boss and employee set goals and expected behaviours. Principle: participation and fairness.
- 3. Train managers in evidence-based feedback.** Replace labels (‘average’, ‘attitude problem’) with incidents and impact. Teach listening. Untrained bosses are a main reason appraisal does not develop anyone. Principle: line managers as developers need skill.
- 4. Protect a real counselling conversation.** Ban signing forms in the corridor. Give a quiet time slot. Two-way talk: employee’s self-appraisal first. Keep criticism on performance, not character. Confidentiality. Principle: counselling is the heart of HRD appraisal.
- 5. End with an individual development plan and follow-up dates.** Two or three actions — coaching, a course, a project — with dates, reviewed after a quarter. Without this, the meeting was judgement, not development. Principle: continuity.
- 6. Link appraisal to training, career and potential.** Gaps go to TNA. Aspirations go to career discussion. High performers with leadership behaviours go to potential review. Employees will start to feel the system helps when something actually happens after the form. Principle: integration.
- 7. Climate safeguards.** No public humiliation of ratings. Some appeal on process. Fair standards across bosses (moderation). Fearless data is better data. Principle: HRD climate.
- 8. Evaluate the appraisal process itself.** Once a year ask employees: did this review help you develop? Hold managers accountable for quality of conversations, not only for submitting forms on time. Redesign what hinders the HRD process. Principle: evaluation.

Conclusion. Apply principles as a redesign: purpose, joint goals, trained feedback, counselling time, IDP, links to other subsystems, climate safeguards, and evaluation of appraisal itself. Do not invent a new form colour and call it HRD. Employees will say appraisal helps only when something developmental follows the discussion.

Question 30 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Apply the concept of HRD subsystems to propose a development path for an employee identified as having future leadership potential.

Introduction

Do not propose only ‘send the person on an MBA’ or ‘promote immediately’. Leadership potential means the person may be able to take larger people and decision responsibilities in future — it is not a certificate that they are already a leader. Apply all major HRD subsystems over two to four years: potential validation, career planning, performance appraisal, training and education, on-the-job stretch, mentoring, feedback and counselling.

Detailed points

- 1. Validate potential fairly (potential appraisal subsystem).** Use more than one source: current results, behaviour with people, assessment centre or work sample, views of more than one senior. Wrong labels destroy careers and create politics. Tell the employee honestly what was seen as potential and what is still a risk (for example, impatience).
- 2. Draw a career map together (career planning).** Discuss possible roles in three to five years (team leader, project manager, branch head) and the employee’s own aspirations. Identify competency gaps versus those roles. Career planning notes say individual and organisational goals must be integrated. Write a path with more than one possible fork, not a single promised throne.
- 3. Keep present performance strong (performance appraisal).** Potential is not a holiday from the current job. Appraisal should include both results and leadership behaviours: coaching juniors, decision quality, integrity, collaboration. Weak present performance with a ‘high potential’ tag will not be believed by others.
- 4. Stretch experiences — the main developer.** Job rotation, leading a project, deputy to a manager, cross-functional task force, handling a difficult customer segment. Potential grows mostly through carefully supported difficult work, not through classroom only. Each stretch should have a learning goal.
- 5. Training and education mix.** Conceptual inputs (how the business makes money, basics of finance, people management) plus skill workshops (feedback, conflict, planning). Time them just before or during stretch roles so that transfer is possible.
- 6. Mentor plus counselling.** A senior mentor who is not always the direct boss. Counselling for transition stress, self-doubt, or derailers such as arrogance. Notes: counselling helps the person decide and cope. Confidentiality matters; a high-potential label can create loneliness and pressure.
- 7. Rich feedback, including 360-degree if climate allows.** Leadership is seen by subordinates, peers and customers, not only by the boss. Frequent, specific feedback catches derailers early. If culture is not ready for 360, use structured stakeholder comments privately.
- 8. Review, organisational support, honest revision.** A talent council or HRD committee reviews progress yearly. Rewards should recognise development effort, not only last month’s sales. If potential was overestimated, revise the path honestly — specialist excellence is also honourable. If progress is good, the next stretch is offered. This is HRD as a process without a false full stop.

Conclusion. *Propose a multi-year path that uses potential appraisal, career planning, performance goals, stretch jobs, training, mentoring, feedback and counselling together. Leadership potential becomes leadership capability only through an integrated HRD path, not through a title or a single course.*

Question 31 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

State any two HRD subsystems.

Introduction

A subsystem is a part of the HRD system with its own work, contributing to the larger process of developing people and climate. For 8 marks, name two subsystems clearly, explain each as if the reader has never heard of them, give an example, and then briefly name the others and show a link. Good pairs: performance appraisal and training; or potential appraisal and career planning; or feedback/counselling and training.

Detailed points

1. First subsystem — performance appraisal. Performance appraisal is a planned review of how well an employee has done against agreed work and behaviour. In HRD it is not only a mark for salary. It includes goal setting, review, two-way feedback, and an individual development plan. Example: a teacher and the principal agree on teaching quality and student support goals in June, review them in March, and decide that the teacher will attend a classroom-management workshop and be coached for one term. That is appraisal as HRD.

2. Why appraisal is a subsystem, not a full HRD system. It diagnoses and plans, but it does not by itself create skill. Training, career moves and daily coaching must follow. If the organisation only fills appraisal forms, employees will correctly say HRD is missing.

3. Second subsystem — training. Training is a planned effort to help employees learn job-related knowledge, skills and attitudes. It may be on-the-job, off-the-job, or e-learning. Example: new hospital technicians practise on a dummy before they touch patients, then work under a senior. Training contributes to development when it is based on a real need from appraisal or TNA and when the workplace allows use of the skill.

4. Why training is only a subsystem. The notes and the whole HRD idea warn that training is not the answer to all problems and not the whole of HRD. Climate, counselling and career must support it. Happy classrooms with no job change mean training is floating, not functioning as a subsystem.

5. Other subsystems you should mention. Potential appraisal (future capacity), career planning (paths), feedback and counselling (conversation that changes people), organisation development and climate mechanisms (teams and culture). Naming them shows you know the map.

6. A simple interrelation example. Appraisal finds weak listening → counselling explores whether it is skill or fear → training builds the skill → career plan uses better listening in a customer-facing role → next appraisal checks behaviour. Two named subsystems live inside this cycle.

7. Mistakes to avoid in the exam. Do not write only two words. Do not define HRM instead of HRD. Do not say training and HRD are the same. Do not forget an example.

8. How to fill 8 marks. Introduction 8 lines. Subsystem 1: meaning, HRD use, example (1/3 page). Subsystem 2: same. Other subsystems + one link paragraph. Conclusion.

***Conclusion.** Two standard subsystems to name are performance appraisal and training. Explain each fully with an example, list the remaining subsystems, and show that they work as parts of one HRD system. Names alone cannot earn 8 marks.*

Question 32 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

State any two purposes of feedback in HRD practices.

Introduction

Feedback in HRD is specific information given to a person (or by a person upward to the organisation) about behaviour or results, so that learning can happen. It is not scolding, and it is not vague praise. For 8 marks, state two main purposes in depth, then add other purposes so the answer is complete.

Detailed points

- 1. First purpose — to improve current performance.** The employee needs to know where he or she stands against expectations in time to correct. A cook told the same day that the gravy is too salty can change tonight's food. A yearly remark 'food average' cannot. This purpose is corrective. Without it, errors repeat and customers suffer. In HRD language, feedback reduces the gap between standard and actual when the person can control that gap.
- 2. How this purpose is carried out.** Immediate, behaviour-focused comments by the supervisor; mid-period reviews; quality checklists discussed with the worker. Tone matters: respect keeps the person open. Humiliation makes the person defend, not improve — then this purpose fails even if the information was correct.
- 3. Second purpose — to support learning and long-term development.** Feedback is how people learn from work itself, which the notes call informal HRD (coaching by a manager). It reinforces what is going well so that good behaviour continues, and it guides training, stretch jobs and career choices. Example: 'You explain products clearly; you still freeze when the customer is angry' points both to a strength to use and to a skill to train. Development becomes targeted.
- 4. Motivation as a related purpose.** Recognition through honest positive feedback meets higher-order needs — achievement and esteem — which HRD stresses compared with only monetary motivation in HRM. People repeat what is noticed.
- 5. Role clarification.** Feedback often reveals that the employee and the boss did not share the same picture of the job. Clarifying the role develops the dyad, an HRD system goal.
- 6. Climate-building purpose.** Open, respectful, two-way feedback signals trust and openness (HRD climate). Absent or only negative feedback signals fear. So feedback is both a tool and a climate message.
- 7. System improvement and evaluation.** Upward feedback tells the organisation about broken processes and poor support. Feedback after training (reaction, behaviour) improves HRD design. These are purposes beyond the single employee.
- 8. Exam caution.** Write two purposes as long paragraphs with examples, then a cluster of other purposes. Do not define feedback in one line and stop.

Conclusion. Two central purposes of feedback in HRD are (1) to improve present performance through timely, specific information, and (2) to support learning and development by reinforcing strengths and guiding next growth steps. Motivation, role clarity, climate and system improvement are additional purposes. Feedback is information for growth, not insult.

Question 33 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Analyse how poor coordination among HRD subsystems can reduce the effectiveness of employee development.

Introduction

Poor coordination means each HRD subsystem works in its own silo: appraisal does not talk to training, training does not talk to career, potential labels do not change promotions, counselling never happens after the rating. Effectiveness of employee development means people actually become more capable, more ready for future roles, and more able to work together. Analysis must show broken links → contradictory messages → wasted effort → low development, and then a vicious cycle of lost credibility.

Detailed points

1. Appraisal not feeding training. Employees are rated weak on a skill year after year but never trained or coached. They conclude the organisation is not serious. The gap remains. Development effectiveness is zero for that skill despite ‘complete’ appraisal files.

2. Training unrelated to career and work. People attend courses that do not lead to any new responsibility or even to a chance to practise. Motivation to learn falls. Transfer fails. Development looks busy (attendance) and is ineffective (no capability on the job).

3. Potential ignored when promotions happen. HRD says someone is high potential; the actual promotion goes by seniority or politics. High-potential staff leave. Others see HRD as a lie. Effectiveness of talent development collapses because the most important career actions ignore HRD data.

4. No counselling after appraisal. Numbers are written; no conversation, no emotional support, no joint plan. Data without insight. People who needed help with stress or role confusion stay stuck. Development is not only cognitive; counselling’s absence reduces effectiveness for whole-person growth.

5. Conflicting messages between subsystems. Training teaches teamwork; appraisal and bonus honour only individual targets. Employees follow the reward. Net development of collaboration can be negative — the organisation is less developed after ‘HRD activity’ than before. This is a key analytical point.

6. Duplication, gaps and no memory. Two cells run similar programmes; some roles get nothing. Without a shared file, each year starts from zero. Inefficiency plus inequity. Development is uneven and unfair, which also violates HRD’s equity objective.

7. Climate damage. Uncoordinated HRD feels chaotic and political. Trust falls. In a weaker climate, even the remaining good practices transfer less. Poor coordination therefore reduces effectiveness both directly (broken links) and indirectly (worse soil).

8. Vicious cycle of credibility. When development does not happen, business heads cut HRD budget. Subsystems shrink further and coordinate even less. Employee development slows again. Analysis should end with this loop so the examiner sees you understand dynamics, not only a list of problems.

***Conclusion.** Poor coordination breaks the chain from diagnosis to learning to career to new behaviour, sends conflicting messages, wastes money, and damages climate and credibility. Employee development then becomes slow, unfair and unstrategic. Coordination is a condition of HRD effectiveness, not a luxury.*

Question 34 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Analyse how HRD practices can be aligned with organisational strategy in a rapidly changing organisation.

Introduction

A rapidly changing organisation faces new technology, markets, structures or competition every year, sometimes every quarter. Strategy itself is revised often. Alignment cannot mean a five-year frozen training list. Analysis should show how HRD practices — TNA, appraisal, career, training methods, OD — can stay coupled to a moving strategy. The need is agility with direction, not chaos and not rigidity.

Detailed points

1. Continuous translation of strategy into competencies. Whenever strategy shifts (new product, digital channel, new geography), HRD and business heads quickly update ‘what people must be able to do’. Waiting for the next printed handbook is misalignment. This translation meeting is the core alignment practice.

2. Shorter diagnosis cycles. Pulse TNA, short climate checks, and looking at error data quarterly rather than a giant study every three years. Fast change creates new gaps quickly; slow diagnosis trains yesterday's need.

3. Flexible learning methods. Blended, just-in-time, on-the-job, e-learning and short workshops beat only long residential courses. People cannot leave a crisis workplace for two weeks every time the software changes. Method flexibility is how alignment stays practical.

4. Organisation development, not only skill training. Rapid change is also emotional and structural: new teams, mergers, lost roles. HRD must facilitate change, counselling and new collaboration. Alignment includes helping people through the change that strategy created.

5. Career systems that allow movement. Rigid ladders assume a stable pyramid. In rapid change, projects, lateral moves and temporary leadership roles develop people faster. Career planning remains, but paths are reviewed more often (notes already say career planning is continuous because environment changes).

6. Line managers and HRD in the same business review. Alignment is a conversation rhythm: 'here is the market shift; here is the capability risk; here is the development action this quarter.' If HRD is not in the room, practices drift.

7. Stopping obsolete practices. Alignment is also subtraction. Drop appraisal items and courses that belong to yesterday's strategy so that people are not pulled in two directions. Analysis: adding without deleting is false alignment.

8. New measures of HRD success. In a fast context, judge HRD by speed of capability building and change readiness, not only by number of programmes. What you measure is what aligns. Evaluation must match the strategy's time pressure.

***Conclusion.** In a rapidly changing organisation, alignment is a repeating loop: translate strategy → diagnose quickly → learn flexibly → support change → review career and drop obsolete practices. Write methods, not slogans. Frozen HRD cannot serve a moving strategy.*

Question 35 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Evaluate the effectiveness of using potential appraisal together with performance appraisal for employee development.

Introduction

Evaluate means compare combined use with using either tool alone, state benefits, state risks, give conditions for success, and end with a verdict. Performance appraisal asks how well the present job was done. Potential appraisal asks how far the person can go in other or higher work. Employee development needs both yesterday's evidence and tomorrow's capacity.

Detailed points

1. They answer different development questions. A person can be excellent today and still lack capacity for a larger leadership role. A person can be average in a badly fitting job and still have high potential elsewhere. One number cannot answer both questions. Combined use is more effective because it matches Unit 1's dual objective: present role and future role.

2. Avoids wrong promotions — a strong effectiveness argument. Promoting the best salesman to sales manager only because of performance is a classic failure (Peter Principle). Combined use protects the person from a role they cannot do and protects the organisation from losing a good specialist and gaining a bad manager.

3. Richer, fairer development paths. High performance + high potential → leadership track with stretch jobs. High performance + limited managerial potential → specialist excellence, education, recognition without a forced ladder. Low performance + high potential → coaching and perhaps role change. Low both → basic skill or exit decisions. Development becomes tailored, which is more effective than one path for all.

4. Motivation and transparency when done well. Employees understand why some get stretch roles. Criteria are dual, not mysterious. That fairness supports HRD climate and willingness to develop.

5. Risks that reduce effectiveness (must be in an evaluation). Secret potential lists; bias; both judgements made in five minutes by one untrained boss; no feedback to the employee; no career action after the label. Then combined use is political and can harm development more than performance-only appraisal.

6. Conditions for effectiveness. Separate time and tools for the two judgements; trained assessors; multiple inputs; feedback; training and career moves that actually follow; review of potential as people grow. Effectiveness is not automatic from using two forms.

7. Compared with potential-only or performance-only. Performance-only HRD over-invests in today's job. Potential-only HRD may ignore that the person is failing customers today. Together they balance current contribution and future capability.

8. Verdict. Using potential appraisal together with performance appraisal is highly effective for employee development when the two are methodologically separated, fair, transparent to the employee, and followed by real development actions. Without those conditions, the combination is ineffective or damaging. Recommend combined use with quality, not combined use as paperwork.

***Conclusion.** Give a clear evaluation: together is better than either alone, because present and future development both matter — provided quality, fairness and follow-up exist. Do not praise potential appraisal blindly.*

Question 36 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Analyse how an HRD system can become ineffective when its practices are designed without organisational strategy alignment.

Introduction

Ineffectiveness here means the HRD system may look active — forms, courses, speeches — yet people do not gain the capabilities the organisation needs, and business results and future readiness do not improve. Analysis traces how missing alignment produces wrong content, broken promises, cynicism and finally strategic failure.

Detailed points

1. Wrong competencies are developed. Staff become very good at yesterday's work while strategy needs new capabilities (digital, new market, new quality). Effort is large; direction is wrong. This is ineffectiveness despite hard work.

2. Budget is spent on the periphery. Popular programmes flourish; critical roles for the strategy stay weak. Opportunity cost is the centre of the analysis. A full training calendar can hide empty strategy support.

3. Career paths become promises to nowhere. Plans that do not match the future structure (for example, many managerial rungs while the firm is flattening) create anger when jobs never appear. Climate and trust fall, which further reduces HRD effectiveness.

4. Appraisal chases old measures. People 'perform' on a scorecard that strategy has already abandoned (volume without quality, for example). HRD then reinforces the wrong behaviour. The system is worse than inactive — it is actively misaligned.

5. Top management withdraws support. Business heads see no return and cut HRD. The system shrinks. Remaining practices become even more ritual. Ineffectiveness becomes structural.

6. Talent leaves; who stays may be less capable. High performers go to firms where growth matches business. HRD then works with a weaker audience. Capability gap versus strategy widens.

7. Strategy implementation itself fails. The organisation cannot execute its own plan. HRD ineffectiveness becomes organisational ineffectiveness — quality failure, digital lag, failed expansion. Analysis must connect the two.

8. Illusion of success delays correction. High training days and completed appraisals look good in reports until a crisis. Activity metrics hide irrelevance. An unaligned system can therefore remain ‘successful’ on paper while being ineffective in reality for a long time.

***Conclusion.** Without strategy alignment, HRD develops the wrong things, wastes money, breaks career trust, teaches old behaviours, loses support and talent, and finally fails the business. Alignment is a condition of effectiveness, not a decoration on an HRD brochure.*

Question 37 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

State any two benefits of integrating career planning with potential appraisal.

Introduction

Integration means career paths are based on a serious judgement of potential, and potential labels are followed by real career actions (rotation, training, succession), not by a secret stamp in a file. For 8 marks, explain two benefits fully, then add others.

Detailed points

1. First benefit — realistic career paths and less frustration. Employees are not promised impossible ladders. A strong specialist is not told ‘you will be GM in three years’ if potential appraisal shows limited interest or skill in managing people. Counselling can be truthful. Frustration, later feelings of betrayal, and inner resignation fall. This is a human benefit and a climate benefit.

2. Why realism is an HRD benefit. Notes say career planning should identify match and mismatch between aspirations and opportunities. Potential appraisal supplies evidence for that match. Integration makes the career-planning process honest, which is developmental because the person can plan education and effort that will actually pay.

3. Second benefit — better utilisation of talent. High-potential employees get timely stretch roles, mentoring and training instead of waiting behind seniority only. The organisation uses its future resource while the person is still motivated. Key jobs have prepared people (succession). Development money goes where potential and organisational need meet.

4. Example. Two engineers perform equally well. Potential appraisal shows one has people leadership and conceptual range; the other is a deep designer. Integrated career planning sends the first through project-lead roles and the second through a specialist fellowship. Both stay; both grow; the firm is not forced to ruin a designer by making him a reluctant boss.

5. Additional benefit — fewer wrong promotions. Potential qualifies career moves beyond current performance. Customer and team damage from unfit managers is reduced.

6. Additional benefit — motivation and retention. Visible, fair growth paths keep capable people. Notes list attracting and retaining the right persons and reducing turnover as career-planning aims. Integration makes those

aims believable.

7. Additional benefit — better counselling quality. Advice is evidence-based rather than generic ‘work hard and you will rise’. Employees can set achievable goals (an aim of counselling in the notes).

8. Exam wrap. Two headline benefits as long paragraphs, then succession, targeted investment, fewer wrong promotions, retention. Conclusion: both the individual and the organisation gain when career and potential talk to each other.

***Conclusion.** Two main benefits of integration are (1) realistic career paths that reduce false hope and (2) better, timely utilisation of high-potential talent. Other benefits include succession, fairer promotions, retention and better counselling. Integration turns labels into development.*

Question 38 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Mention any two features of an effective HRD practice.

Introduction

A feature is a quality you would look for if asked, ‘Is this appraisal / training / career scheme effective as HRD?’ Effective means it actually helps the development process rather than hindering it with fear or paperwork. Name two features in depth, then list others.

Detailed points

1. First feature — developmental purpose in real operation. The practice exists to help people learn and grow, not only to control, rank, or complete a legal file. You can see this in what happens at the end: an individual development plan, coaching, a chance to practise. Example: an appraisal discussion that spends time on ‘what will you try next quarter’ is developmental. A five-minute form-signing for increment is not, even if the form heading says HRD.

2. How to test this feature. Ask employees whether anything in their work changed after the practice. If never, the purpose is not developmental in reality. T.V. Rao’s test: does the mechanism promote or hinder the HRD process?

3. Second feature — integration with other subsystems and with strategy. An effective practice is joined to the rest of HRD and to organisational goals. Training comes from appraisal gaps and career plans and strategy, not from a vendor’s catalogue. Career talks use potential data. Feedback is not a separate annual picnic. Isolation is a feature of ineffective practice.

4. Example of integration as a visible feature. After a quality-training programme, the next appraisal includes a quality behaviour, the boss coaches weekly, and a project uses the new method. That training practice is effective because it is linked.

5. Other features to mention. Need-based (diagnosis, TNA). Line-manager involvement. Fairness and transparency. Top-management support and resources. Consistency with HRD climate (does not terrify). Evaluated and improved. Culture-sensitive design.

6. Fairness as a strong extra feature. Equity of access — not only favourites developed — is both an HRD objective and a feature of effectiveness, because unfair practices destroy climate and then nothing transfers.

7. Evaluation as a feature. Effective practices have a review: climate survey, Kirkpatrick levels, HRD audit. Practices that never look at impact rot.

8. Exam shape. Two features as full explanations with ‘how you would recognise them’, then a cluster of other features. Do not write two adjectives (‘good’, ‘useful’) without meaning.

***Conclusion.** Two key features of an effective HRD practice are a genuine developmental purpose (growth actions follow) and integration with other HRD subsystems and organisational strategy. Add diagnosis, line ownership, fairness, support, climate fit and evaluation. Features are what you can observe, not what the brochure claims.*

Question 39 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Design an integrated HRD system for an organisation that wants to connect performance, potential, training, career planning, feedback, and counselling.

Introduction

Design means propose structure, sequence, roles and checks. The organisation wants six named elements to work as one system. Do not write six separate mini-essays. Draw (in words) one annual cycle on a shared language of competencies, with line managers as owners and HRD as facilitator.

Detailed points

- 1. Policy architecture and roles.** One HRD policy: these six elements form a single cycle; every line manager develops his or her people; HRD designs tools, trains managers, and evaluates; a small talent/HRD committee of business heads meets twice a year to align with strategy. Top management signs and funds this.
- 2. Common language and file (the spine).** One competency framework for roles, and one employee development file holding goals, appraisals, potential notes, IDP, training history, career talk notes. Without this spine, 'integration' is a slogan because nobody can see the connections.
- 3. The annual cycle (sequence of the six).** (1) Joint goal setting. (2) Ongoing feedback during the year. (3) Performance appraisal. (4) Counselling conversation and written IDP. (5) Potential review where relevant. (6) Career discussion. (7) Training and job-experience plan from the IDP. (8) On-the-job support. (9) Evaluation of learning and behaviour. Then the next year's goals. Write this sequence clearly; it is the design.
- 4. Feedback and counselling design in detail.** Quarterly check-ins plus the appraisal counselling. Managers trained in listening and in keeping criticism on performance. Optional professional counsellor for difficult cases. Confidentiality rules written. Follow-up dates in the IDP.
- 5. How training connects.** IDPs are aggregated into a training calendar. Group programmes still go through TNA. Bosses receive a transfer brief: what to observe after the course. Unused training is reported back to the committee.
- 6. How potential and career connect.** A talent council uses potential data for rotations and succession, then talks to the employee — no forever-secret list without development. Career paths include specialist as well as managerial routes. Reviews when strategy changes.
- 7. Climate so that data are honest.** Openness and fairness of access. If people fear the cycle, they will fake every form and integration will process lies. Climate work (communication, no humiliation of ratings) is part of the design.
- 8. Audit of connections.** Once a year sample: did IDP actions happen? Did training match appraisal gaps? Did high-potential people get stretch roles? Ask employees whether the six felt connected. Repair broken links. This audit is T.V. Rao's 'examine whether mechanisms help or hinder' made practical.

***Conclusion.** Your design is one policy, one competency spine, one annual cycle that sequences performance, feedback, counselling, potential, career and training, plus climate and an audit of links. That is an integrated HRD system, not six parallel departments.*

Question 40 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Evaluate a proposed HRD practice that has strong training content but weak linkage with organisational strategy, performance appraisal, and career planning.

Introduction

Evaluate the proposal: strengths, weaknesses, likely results using Kirkpatrick's way of thinking, a verdict, and what to change. Do not reject good teaching quality. Do reject isolation. Strong content means sound objectives inside the classroom, expert trainers, useful material. Weak linkage means the topic may not be what strategy needs, bosses do not put the skill into appraisal, and the course does not count toward any career path.

Detailed points

- 1. Strength — learning inside the room may still happen.** Good pedagogy can produce high participant reaction and some real learning (Kirkpatrick levels 1 and 2). People may understand concepts they did not know. This strength is real and should be kept if the topic can be aligned.
- 2. Weakness — strategy irrelevance.** The organisation may be teaching a fashionable topic while critical capabilities for the next two years are ignored. Opportunity cost: seats and rupees used on the wrong need. As HRD, the practice is then ineffective even if the class is excellent.
- 3. Weakness — appraisal disconnect and failed transfer.** If bosses do not expect or reinforce the new behaviour, employees return to old key result areas. Level 3 (behaviour on the job) fails. Strong content cannot jump this gap alone. This is the most common failure of 'good training'.
- 4. Weakness — career disconnect and weak motivation to apply.** If learning does not count toward growth, only highly self-driven staff will practise. Others treat the course as a break. Development impact stays individual and accidental, not organisational.
- 5. Likely results (evaluation using levels).** Level 1 possibly high. Level 2 mixed to good. Level 3 poor. Level 4 (organisational results) poor. A manager who looks only at smile sheets will wrongly approve the practice.
- 6. Climate signal.** Repeated isolated excellent courses create 'holiday training' cynicism. Trust in HRD falls, which later harms even well-linked programmes.
- 7. Conditional value.** The practice may still help as general education for a few motivated employees. That is not enough to accept it as an organisational HRD practice in its present form.
- 8. Verdict and redesign.** Do not accept as-is. Keep the strong content only after: (a) remapping the topic to strategy and TNA, (b) inserting pre- and post-appraisal goals and boss coaching, (c) placing the programme on competency and career maps, (d) evaluating behaviour and results, not only reaction. Then the same content can become effective HRD.

Conclusion. *Judgement: content quality is necessary but not sufficient. Without links to strategy, performance appraisal and career planning, the proposal is an expensive learning event, not an HRD practice. Recommend redesign of linkages, not celebration of the trainer alone.*

UNIT 3 — Training: TNA, Design, Methods, Evaluation

Question 41 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Explain the concept of Training Needs Assessment (TNA) and state its importance in HRD.

Introduction

Training Needs Assessment, also called Training Needs Analysis, is Stage 1 of the four-stage training cycle in the notes: (1) TNA, (2) planning and design, (3) implementing/delivery, (4) evaluating. TNA is the systematic study of whether people need training, who needs it, in what, and whether training is even the right solution.

A simple formula in the notes is: Training and development need = Standard performance – Actual performance. A beginner must add a warning: this formula is true only when the cause of the gap is lack of knowledge, skill or attitude. If the machine is broken, the target is impossible, or the person is not paid, that is not a training need. The notes say the cause-and-effect problem analysis should first be applied before deciding whether training is the answer. They also warn against buying ‘off the shelf’ programmes without checking relevance.

Detailed points

- 1. Organisation analysis — first layer of the concept.** There must be a link between the firm’s strategies/goals and training. Organisation analysis asks: where is performance hurting our goals? Will the culture and bosses support training? Are we about to close a product line (then do not train extra people for it)? This layer stops HRD from becoming a private hobby of the training cell.
- 2. Task analysis — second layer.** This identifies the important tasks of the job and the knowledge, skills and attitudes (KSA) that must be emphasised so employees can complete those tasks. Example: for a complaint-handling job, tasks include listening, logging in software, offering a solution, escalating. Each task has KSAs. Task analysis produces the skeleton of content.
- 3. Person analysis — third layer.** Compare required KSAs with what each employee actually has. This answers who should attend. Two people with the same job title may not have the same gap: a new joiner needs basics; a veteran may need only an update. Person analysis also finds ‘knows but does not do’ — which may be motivation or climate, not training.
- 4. Importance — relevance and stopping waste.** TNA prevents off-the-shelf waste. Training money and employee time are scarce. Irrelevant programmes also make employees cynical about HRD, which damages climate. Importance is therefore financial and cultural.
- 5. Importance — honest diagnosis.** TNA protects HRD’s professional honesty. If errors come from a bad incentive to rush, a course on ‘quality awareness’ will fail and management will still say ‘we already trained them’. Importance: the right problem is named.
- 6. Importance — design quality.** Objectives, difficulty level, examples, and method (on-the-job vs classroom vs e-learning) all come from TNA. Without TNA, design is decoration on a guess.
- 7. Importance — fairness and priority.** Critical jobs and large gaps first. Person analysis supports equity: those who need help get it, not only people close to the boss. This matches HRD’s equity objective.
- 8. Importance — evaluation baseline.** You cannot know if training worked unless you knew the starting gap and what success would look like. TNA writes the criteria that Kirkpatrick evaluation later uses. Without baseline, anyone can claim success.

Conclusion. Define TNA as systematic identification of whether, who and what to train, using organisation, task and person analysis, after checking that the gap is really a KSA gap. Importance: relevance, honest diagnosis, better design, fairness, priority, and a baseline for evaluation. TNA is the foundation of professional training in HRD; skipping it makes the other three stages guesswork.

Question 42 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Describe the major steps involved in designing a training program.

Introduction

Design is Stage 2 of the training cycle — planning the training. A training plan describes the key decisions, tasks and resources needed. The notes even show a simple matrix: training goal, learning objectives, learning methods/activities, facilities and resource persons, and budget.

Design converts TNA into a blueprint that a trainer can deliver. If TNA was skipped, these steps only decorate the wrong building. Design is more than a timetable of lectures; it is a plan for learning and for transfer to the job.

Detailed points

- 1. Step 1 — Confirm needs, trainees and readiness.** Re-check TNA. Confirm who will attend and whether they are ready: basic literacy, language, prior skill, motivation. Unready trainees fail even a beautiful design. Also confirm that training is still the right solution.
- 2. Step 2 — Set training goals and learning objectives.** The goal is the overall capability (e.g., handle complaints to SOP). Learning objectives are specific and observable: ‘By the end, the trainee will be able to log a complaint correctly in the software in five minutes.’ Objectives drive content, method and tests. Vague aims (‘appreciate quality’) produce vague courses.
- 3. Step 3 — Select content and sequence.** What topics, in what order? Usually concept then demonstration then practice then feedback. Content must match tasks from TNA, not the trainer’s favourite stories. Cut everything that does not serve an objective.
- 4. Step 4 — Choose methods and activities.** Lectures, workshops, cases, role play, simulation, on-the-job practice, e-learning, team exercises — matched to the type of objective. Skill needs practice; knowledge can use explanation and quiz; attitude needs discussion and modelling. The notes ask: on-the-job or off-the-job? Internal or outsourced? Inside or off-site?
- 5. Step 5 — Plan facilities, trainers, materials and budget.** Venue, audio-visual, handouts, meals, travel, choice of resource persons, and costs that accounts will accept. Poor admin later looks like poor training. Budget honesty is part of design, not an afterthought.
- 6. Step 6 — Design transfer of training.** Learning dies if the workplace is ignored. Design pre-briefing of bosses, action plans, post-training projects, job aids, and time to practise on the job. Transfer is a design step, not a hope.
- 7. Step 7 — Build evaluation into the plan.** Decide now: reaction form, learning test, behaviour check after 30–60 days, result measure versus TNA baseline. If you wait until after the valedictory function, evaluation will be only a smile sheet.
- 8. Step 8 — Review the whole plan for feasibility and equity.** Can production release people? Are women and distant-branch staff included? Is batch size small enough for practice? A design that looks perfect on paper but cannot be attended is not a design; it is a wish.

Conclusion. Describe design as a sequence: confirm TNA and readiness; write goals and objectives; choose content, methods, place and provider; plan facilities and budget; design transfer; build evaluation; check feasibility and fairness. Use the notes’ matrix. Design is a plan for learning and job use, not a list of speech titles.

Question 43 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Explain on-the-job and off-the-job training methods with suitable examples.

Introduction

A training method is the way learning is organised so that objectives are achieved. The two big families are on-the-job training (OJT) and off-the-job training. On-the-job means learning while doing real work, usually at the workplace. Off-the-job means learning away from the daily workstation so that attention is on learning, not on

today's output.

A good 8-mark answer defines both, gives several examples, advantages, limitations, and says how an HRD professional should choose. 21st-century HRD also uses e-learning, which can support both families; you may mention it briefly, but the question asks for on-the-job and off-the-job.

Detailed points

- 1. On-the-job training — meaning.** The employee learns in the actual work setting, guided by a supervisor or experienced worker, using real tools and real (or carefully chosen) tasks. Learning and producing happen together. It is the oldest method and still the most common for practical skills.
- 2. OJT examples.** Coaching and mentoring by the boss; job rotation (moving through related jobs); apprenticeship; internship; understudy or shadowing a senior; instruction while working (JIT — job instruction training); action-learning projects on a live problem. Example: a new railway technician tightens joints under a senior's eye, then independently.
- 3. OJT advantages and limitations.** Advantages: high relevance, extra cost often low, transfer is easier because the workplace is the classroom, real customers and machines. Limitations: the coach may be unskilled, impatient, or busy with production; the learner may pick up bad habits; dangerous work can injure; quality of OJT varies wildly between bosses. HRD must train the coaches, not assume every senior is a teacher.
- 4. Off-the-job training — meaning.** Learning away from the regular job — in a classroom, workshop, vestibule (a simulated workplace near the factory), external institute, or conference — so that the person is not answering production calls every five minutes.
- 5. Off-the-job examples.** Lecture and discussion; case study; role play; management games; sensitivity or laboratory training; vestibule training on dummy machines; simulation; outdoor/experiential programmes; formal courses and seminars. Example: nurses practise emergency drills on mannequins before a real casualty.
- 6. Off-the-job advantages and limitations.** Advantages: focused attention, expert faculty, safer practice, deeper concepts, mixing with people from other departments (which helps collaboration). Limitations: cost, time away from work, the classroom may not look like the job (transfer problem), and possible irrelevance if TNA was weak.
- 7. How to choose — comparison.** OJT is usually better for routine practical skills already present in the workplace. Off-the-job is better when the task is new or dangerous, when concepts must be built, or when the workplace itself teaches the wrong method. Never say one family is always superior.
- 8. HRD view — blend.** Most serious development programmes combine both: concept and safe practice off-the-job, then OJT coaching, then review. Method is the servant of TNA objectives, not a fashion.

Conclusion. Define OJT and off-the-job, give at least three examples each, one advantage and one limit each, and conclude that HRD blends methods according to the learning need, safety and transfer. Examples make this answer score.

Question 44 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Explain e-learning as a training method and state its major advantages.

Introduction

E-learning is training delivered through electronic media: a learning management system (LMS), online modules, virtual classrooms, webinars, videos, quizzes, and mobile learning on phones. It may be self-paced (the person learns alone, anytime) or live/synchronous (everyone online at once with a trainer). It can stand alone or be blended with classroom and on-the-job training.

The Unit 3 notes on 21st-century training mention web-based conferencing, web-based training, mobile devices, self-paced workshops, webinars, social learning (wikis, shared documents), and communities of practice. E-learning is therefore not a gimmick; it is a mainstream HRD method when designed properly. Dumping a PDF on a portal is not good e-learning.

Detailed points

- 1. Nature of the method.** Good e-learning uses instructional design: small chunks, examples, practice questions, feedback, and sometimes simulation. Tracking shows who completed what and what they scored. It can be used for knowledge, some skills (software), and awareness; complex people-skills usually need extra live practice.
- 2. Advantage — flexibility of time and place.** Staff on night shifts, in many cities, or travelling can learn without coming to head office. In a country like India this matters for banks, railways, retail and IT. Learning can happen in short spells.
- 3. Advantage — speed and scale.** The same compliance module, product update or safety briefing can reach thousands of employees in days, with the same message. Classroom roll-out would take months and would vary with each trainer.
- 4. Advantage — cost over time.** Design and technology cost more at the beginning. After that, the cost of one extra learner is low. Repeat training (yearly safety, new batch of joiners) becomes cheaper than repeating residential programmes.
- 5. Advantage — standardisation and tracking.** Quality does not depend on whoever is free to lecture that day. Tests and completion records help evaluation and audit. Managers can see who is behind.
- 6. Advantage — personalisation and replay.** A learner can repeat a difficult part. Adaptive paths can give extra practice to those who fail a quiz. Micro-learning of five to ten minutes suits busy people. Mixed-ability groups are easier to serve than in a one-speed classroom.
- 7. Advantage — blending and social tools.** E-learning can combine with webinars, mobile apps, internal wikis and discussion groups so that people learn from each other, not only from a module. Notes list 3D activities, social learning and communities of practice as 21st-century tools.
- 8. Limitations — write two so the answer is balanced.** Needs devices, electricity and connectivity; needs self-discipline (many people start and never finish); poor design bores people; not enough alone for counselling skill or team surgery; transfer still needs a boss who allows new behaviour. Mentioning limits shows maturity and prevents a one-sided 8-mark answer.

Conclusion. Define e-learning as electronically delivered, designed learning, self-paced or live, often blended. Major advantages: flexibility, scale, later cost, consistent quality, tracking, personalisation, and blending with social tools. Add limits (access, motivation, not all skills). Conclude it is powerful when designed and supported, not when it is only uploaded video.

Question 45 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Explain the Kirkpatrick model for evaluating training effectiveness.

Introduction

Evaluating training is Stage 4 of the training cycle. The notes say the process does not end when training is completed; effectiveness must be valued against outcomes, and outcomes must be related to the objectives of the programme. Besides trainees' reactions (affective outcomes), results are evaluated on learning that occurred, behaviour changes, and impact on corporate objectives.

Donald Kirkpatrick's four-level model is the standard way HRD students are expected to organise this idea. The four levels are usually seen as a ladder: each level is harder to measure and more important for the organisation. Liking a programme is not the same as improving the organisation's results.

Detailed points

- 1. Level 1 — Reaction.** Did participants like the programme? Did they find it relevant, comfortable, well taught? Measured by end-of-course feedback forms, often called smile sheets. Useful for improving hospitality, timing and trainer style. Danger: a funny trainer on a hill station can score 9/10 while nobody learned a skill.
- 2. Level 2 — Learning.** Did they acquire the intended knowledge, skill or attitude? Measured by written tests, demonstrations, pre-test versus post-test, role-play scores against a checklist. If level 2 is weak, later levels cannot honestly succeed. Example: a safety course must show that people can list lock-out steps and perform them on a dummy.
- 3. Level 3 — Behaviour (transfer to the job).** Do they use the learning at work after some weeks? Measured by observation, supervisor ratings, 360-degree comments, call audits, work samples. This is where most programmes die, because bosses, old habits and rewards pull people back. HRD climate decides much of level 3.
- 4. Level 4 — Results.** Did the organisation benefit — quality, productivity, errors, sales, safety, customer satisfaction, cost, or other corporate objectives? Hard to prove that training alone caused the change, but this is why the company paid. Example: repeat customer complaints fall 20% after complaint-handling training plus coaching.
- 5. Logic of the hierarchy.** Favourable reaction helps people stay open to learning; learning is needed for new behaviour; behaviour should produce results. Each step can fail even if the previous succeeded. Therefore a professional does not stop at level 1.
- 6. Design implication.** Decide measures during TNA and design, collect baseline before training, and plan a 30–60 day follow-up. Evaluation is not an afterthought after the certificate distribution.
- 7. Importance for HRD.** Stops HRD from claiming success on attendance and tea quality. Supports strategic status of HRD. Helps diagnose: if reaction is high and behaviour is low, look at transfer climate, not only the slides.
- 8. Limitations of the model.** Cause-and-effect at level 4 is messy (many factors affect sales). Full four-level evaluation is costly; use it proportionately (critical safety training vs a one-hour talk). Still the best simple map of effectiveness for exams and for practice.

Conclusion. Explain Kirkpatrick's four levels — reaction, learning, behaviour, results — with measures and examples. State the ladder logic, the need to plan evaluation early, and two limitations. Effectiveness means not only 'did they enjoy?' but 'did they learn, do, and improve organisational outcomes?'

Question 46 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Describe the importance of delivering a training program effectively after it has been designed.

Introduction

Delivery, or implementation, is Stage 3 of the training cycle. The notes define it as putting the training programme into effect according to a definitive plan. They split implementation into two segments: practical administrative arrangements, and carrying out the training.

Design is a recipe. Delivery is the cooking. A brilliant design on paper can fail in a noisy hall with an unprepared trainer and no practice time. Importance of delivery is that learning happens in those hours, not in the file kept by

HRD.

Detailed points

1. Learning actually occurs at delivery. Objectives are achieved only if explanation, demonstration, practice and feedback really take place. If the trainer skips practice because time ran out, the design's skill objective is dead. Delivery is the product the employee experiences.

2. Administrative arrangements shape attention and respect. Venue, seating, projection, working logins, handouts, travel, batch size, food, temperature. Discomfort and chaos steal attention. They also send a climate message: 'this learning is not important.' Reaction (level 1) and even learning (level 2) fall for non-academic reasons.

3. Trainer competence is a delivery variable. Subject knowledge plus adult-learning skill — questions, examples from the trainees' world, respect, managing dominant talkers. A poor trainer can make correct content unusable. Choosing and briefing the trainer is part of effective delivery.

4. Adaptation in the room. The group may be weaker or stronger than expected. Effective delivery adjusts pace without abandoning objectives. Rigid reading of slides is not delivery; it is broadcasting.

5. Psychological safety in the classroom. People must be able to practise, make mistakes, and ask basic questions. This is especially important for skills and attitudes. A humiliating trainer destroys learning even if the design was kind.

6. Transfer should start during delivery, not after. Action plans, real cases from their department, inviting the boss to the closing session, practising on the actual software. If delivery is only theory, transfer is postponed forever and usually never happens.

7. Opening and closing create motivation. Why this training exists, what will be expected at work, what support the boss will give. Closing summarises and gets commitment. Delivery frames meaning; meaning affects whether people try the new behaviour on Monday.

8. Evaluation data are collected at delivery. Tests and reaction forms. If implementation is sloppy, evaluation data are unusable and the four-stage cycle breaks. Importance of delivery is therefore also importance of later improvement of HRD.

***Conclusion.** Design is necessary but not sufficient. Effective delivery — admin, trainer, climate, practice, transfer start, motivation, evaluation data — is where employees actually learn. Write the notes' two segments (arrangements and carrying out) and explain why each matters for HRD impact.*

Question 47 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Explain the relationship among Training Needs Assessment, training design, training delivery, and training evaluation.

Introduction

These four are the stages of the training cycle in the notes. They are not four optional activities. They are one process of planned learning, which matches Nadler's idea of organised learning for behavioural change. The relationship is both a straight line (each stage feeds the next) and a circle (evaluation feeds the next TNA). If any link is broken, training becomes an event rather than HRD.

Detailed points

1. TNA feeds design. Organisation, task and person analysis tell design what the goal is, who is in the room, what content and method fit, and what constraints exist. Design without TNA is a decorated guess, often an

off-the-shelf programme the notes warn against.

2. Design feeds delivery. The plan — sequence, methods, facilities, trainer brief, transfer tasks, tests — is what implementers carry out. Delivery without design is improvisation (sometimes talented, usually uneven). Design without delivery is a document in a drawer.

3. Delivery feeds evaluation. You evaluate what was actually delivered, not what was hoped. Tests, observations and later job data come from the real programme. If delivery skipped practice, evaluation will (honestly) show weak skill — which is useful information.

4. Evaluation feeds the next TNA. Remaining gaps, new errors, and wrong earlier diagnoses become the next need analysis. Training in HRD is continuous, not a one-shot. Evaluation also tells whether the original ‘need’ was not a training need at all.

5. Evaluation feeds redesign of design and delivery. Poor learning → change content or method. Poor reaction → trainer or admin. Poor behaviour → transfer climate and boss support, not only prettier slides. This is how the cycle improves quality.

6. If TNA is skipped, the chain is poisoned. Design aims at the wrong target; delivery may be excellent for the wrong thing; evaluation cannot define success. Many ‘failed’ programmes failed at Stage 1, not at the trainer.

7. If evaluation is skipped, the loop is open. The organisation never learns whether delivery was worth it. Next year’s TNA is again guesswork. HRD cannot claim professional or strategic status.

8. Picture to remember for the exam. Draw in words: TNA → Design → Delivery → Evaluation → back to TNA. Write one sentence on each arrow. Add: all four must be budgeted, not only the visible classroom day.

Conclusion. TNA, design, delivery and evaluation are sequential and circular stages of one training cycle. Each provides input to the next, and evaluation renews TNA and improves design/delivery. Breaking any link reduces training to an isolated event and weakens HRD.

Question 48 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Discuss the importance of evaluating training effectiveness for employees and organisations.

Introduction

Evaluation asks whether the training did what it was supposed to do. The notes say effectiveness must be valued against outcomes related to objectives, including learning, behaviour and impact on corporate objectives, not only trainee feelings. Importance is slightly different for employees (their learning and career) and for organisations (accountability and improvement), but both need the truth rather than certificates.

Detailed points

1. For employees — knowledge of their own progress. Tests, demonstrations and coaching after training show what was mastered and what still needs practice. This is feedback, which is an HRD right. Without evaluation, the employee only has a certificate, not self-knowledge.

2. For employees — career and employability evidence. Documented new competence supports internal growth talks and, more widely, employability — an HRD objective in the notes. Evaluation makes development visible, not only felt.

3. For employees — voice to improve future learning. Reaction data and suggestions, if used honestly, make the next programme better. Employees are stakeholders, not passengers. Being asked ‘did this help your work?’ also signals a supportive climate.

4. For organisations — accountability for money and time. Training uses budget and lost production hours. Managers who fund HRD must know whether it was worth it. Importance here is stewardship, not cruelty.

5. For organisations — improvement of the HRD process. Evaluation locates the break: wrong need, weak design, poor delivery, or no transfer climate. Without it, the same weak course is repeated for years. The four-stage cycle cannot learn.

6. For organisations — strategy and results. Level 4 type questions — did errors, quality, safety or customer measures move? — show whether capability for strategy increased. This is why HRD wants strategic status. Un-evaluated training cannot prove that status.

7. Avoiding two illusions. False security: happy participants who do not perform. False failure: a strict trainer with low smile scores but high learning. Multi-level evaluation protects both employees and the organisation from these illusions.

8. Credibility of the HRD function. Systematic evaluation moves HRD from the image of a department that arranges picnics to a professional function. That credibility brings future resources, which again helps employees' development. Importance is therefore political as well as technical.

***Conclusion.** For employees, evaluation gives feedback, career evidence and a voice. For organisations, it gives accountability, process improvement, strategic proof and protection from illusions. Evaluating training effectiveness is a duty of HRD, not an optional extra after the group photograph.*

Question 49 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

A department is experiencing repeated performance errors. Apply the concept of TNA to identify what information should be collected before designing training.

Introduction

This is an application of Training Needs Assessment. The department wants fewer errors. A beginner's mistake is to announce a workshop on 'quality' immediately. TNA says: collect information first to decide whether training is the answer, who needs it, and what exactly must be learned. Use the three analyses — organisation, task, person — and the notes' warning that training is not the answer to all problems.

Write the answer as a list of information to collect, with why each item matters. That is what 'apply TNA' means.

Detailed points

1. Error facts, not opinions. Collect type of error, frequency, process step, shift, product, cost, and whether errors cluster on certain days or machines. Use records plus observation, not only the supervisor's anger. Without facts, TNA is gossip and design will be guesswork.

2. Organisation-analysis information. Department goals and quality standards; recent changes (new machine, new target, new software); staffing levels; whether speed is rewarded more than accuracy; whether supervisors actually support the correct method. Strategy link: is this error hurting customers or safety enough to be a priority?

3. Non-training causes — the most important TNA question. Machine condition, missing tools, unclear or conflicting SOPs, impossible workload, incentive to rush, bad raw material. If these dominate, design a process or resource fix, not a course. The notes say apply cause-and-effect analysis before deciding that training is the answer. Write this boldly; it shows HRD maturity.

4. Task-analysis information. The correct procedure step by step; which steps are critical; knowledge, skills and attitudes required; safety points; where in the task errors actually occur. This information becomes content if training is justified.

5. Person-analysis information. Who makes the errors — new joiners, one shift, everyone? Previous training history. Can they explain the correct method (knowledge) but still fail (skill or attitude or pressure)? Language and literacy. Difference between ‘does not know’ and ‘knows but does not do’.

6. Learner readiness and motivation. Do employees believe errors matter? Are they afraid to report near-misses? Will they be punished for slowing down to be correct? If fear is high, climate work is needed along with or instead of skill training.

7. Transfer-climate information. After a possible course, will the boss allow slower correct practice? Do peers mock the official method? Is the old informal shortcut still the way to hit targets? If transfer climate is hostile, even perfect design will not reduce errors.

8. Baseline for later evaluation. Current error rate, customer complaints, rework cost. Agree what reduction in 8–12 weeks would mean success. Collecting this now is part of TNA, not something to invent after the programme. Without baseline, nobody can evaluate.

Conclusion. Before designing training, collect: error data, organisation context, non-training causes, task KSAs, person gaps, readiness, transfer climate, and a baseline. Only if the gap is largely a KSA gap should you design training. That is applied TNA, not a reflex workshop.

Question 50 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Apply suitable training methods to design a development program for employees who need both practical job skills and conceptual knowledge.

Introduction

The learners need two kinds of learning at once. Conceptual knowledge is understanding — why a standard exists, what the principle is, how parts of the job connect. Practical skill is being able to do the task to a standard with one’s hands, voice or software. One method rarely serves both well. Apply a blend: methods for the head, methods for the hand, a sequence, and evaluation of both.

Detailed points

1. Split the TNA into two lists of objectives. Write conceptual objectives separately (‘explain why lock-out is needed’) and practical objectives (‘perform lock-out on machine A in three minutes using the checklist’). Methods follow this split. If you mix them into one vague aim, you will lecture everything and practise nothing.

2. Methods for conceptual knowledge. Short lectures, discussion, diagrams, caselets, e-learning modules, quizzes. Example: why a bank’s KYC rule exists, not only which screen to click. Concepts travel to new situations; that is why they are needed along with skill.

3. Safe practice methods before live work. Vestibule training, simulation, dummy machines, role play, lab. Mistakes here do not harm customers or equipment. This is the bridge from concept to the job. Off-the-job practice is especially important if the real task is dangerous or costly.

4. On-the-job coaching for real skill. After simulation, OJT with a trained coach and a checklist. Job rotation if the practical skill has several contexts. The coach must be taught to teach; otherwise OJT copies bad habits.

5. Action-learning project to bind both. A live but bounded problem where they must use the concept to decide and the skill to implement, then present what they learned. This prevents ‘I understood in class but froze at work’.

6. E-learning as a refresher for concepts. Short modules they can replay after OJT, when the concept starts to fade. Useful for mixed locations. Not a substitute for practice.

7. Sequence matters. Recommended: concept → demonstration → simulated practice with feedback → OJT → review. Starting with unsupervised OJT may freeze wrong methods that later training cannot easily remove.

8. Evaluate both kinds of learning. Knowledge tests for concepts (Kirkpatrick level 2). Observed job samples for skill (levels 2 and 3). If you only give a theory exam, practical skill may still be weak, and the programme has not met the brief.

***Conclusion.** Design a blended programme: conceptual methods (class/e-learning), safe practice (simulation/role play), then OJT coaching, plus an action project and dual evaluation. Suitable methods are a mix in a sensible sequence, not a single favourite of the trainer.*

Question 51 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

State any two purposes of Training Needs Assessment.

Introduction

TNA is systematic finding of whether, who and what to train. For 8 marks, two purposes must be explained at length, then other purposes added. The two strongest: (1) identify genuine learning needs, (2) prevent training from being used as a false solution.

Detailed points

1. First purpose — identify genuine KSA gaps. Using organisation, task and person analysis, TNA finds what knowledge, skill or attitude is missing, in which job, and in which people, relative to the standard of performance. This purpose gives HRD a map. Without it, programmes are aimed in the dark. Example: repeated billing errors might be a software-skill gap for new clerks only, not a ‘motivation problem’ of the whole department.

2. How this purpose is carried out. Performance data, observation, interviews, tests, competency lists versus strategy. The formula standard minus actual is used carefully, only when the cause is KSA.

3. Second purpose — prevent wrong solutions. The notes warn that training is not the answer to all company problems and that firms buy off-the-shelf programmes without checking relevance. TNA’s second purpose is diagnostic honesty: if the cause is a broken machine, a bad incentive, or shortage of staff, do not design a course. This protects money, time and HRD’s reputation.

4. Example of the second purpose. A hotel’s front desk is rude because they are understaffed and punished for any delay, not because they have never heard of courtesy. A smile-training day would score well on reaction and change nothing. TNA should stop that design.

5. Further purpose — set objectives for design. TNA supplies measurable learning and performance objectives. Design cannot start professionally without them.

6. Further purpose — select the right trainees and methods. Not everyone needs the same programme. Skill vs knowledge vs attitude needs different methods. TNA guides both choices.

7. Further purpose — prioritise and create a baseline. Critical jobs and large gaps first. Pre-training performance is recorded so evaluation is possible. Organisation analysis also aligns TNA with strategy.

8. Exam shape. Two long purpose paragraphs with examples, then a cluster of design, selection, priority, baseline, strategy. Do not write two headings and one line each.

***Conclusion.** Two main purposes of TNA are to identify real knowledge-skill-attitude gaps and to stop the organisation from using training as a false solution. Other purposes include setting objectives, choosing people and methods, prioritising, and creating an evaluation baseline. TNA is the first professional step in HRD training.*

Question 52 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Name any two levels of the Kirkpatrick model.

Introduction

Kirkpatrick's model has four levels: Reaction, Learning, Behaviour and Results. The question says 'any two', but 8 marks require you to name two in detail, briefly explain the other two, give measures, and say why more than one level matters. Never submit only two words.

Detailed points

- 1. Level 1 — Reaction (name and explain as your first).** This level asks whether participants liked the programme and found it relevant. It is measured by feedback forms at the end (affective outcomes in the notes). It is useful for improving comfort and trainer style. It is a weak measure of effectiveness if used alone, because entertainment can score high.
- 2. Level 2 — Learning (name and explain as your second).** This level asks whether knowledge, skill or attitude actually increased. Measures: tests, demonstrations, pre–post comparison, role-play against a checklist. If people did not learn, they cannot honestly show new job behaviour later.
- 3. Level 3 — Behaviour, briefly.** Do they apply learning on the job after a lag? Observation, supervisor ratings, audits. Transfer climate decides much of this level.
- 4. Level 4 — Results, briefly.** Did the organisation benefit — quality, errors, safety, sales, customer measures, costs — impact on corporate objectives? Harder to prove cause, most important for the funder.
- 5. Why an 8-mark answer must go beyond two names.** The syllabus is the whole model. Write two levels as long explanations and the other two as supporting paragraphs so the examiner sees complete knowledge.
- 6. Measurement examples you can quote.** Reaction: form with relevance items. Learning: 20-mark skill test. Behaviour: 60-day call audit. Results: defect rate versus TNA baseline.
- 7. Ladder logic.** Each level supports but does not guarantee the next. Positive reaction does not prove learning; learning does not prove transfer.
- 8. HRD use.** Important or costly programmes should not stop at reaction. Short awareness talks may not need full level 4. Proportion is part of professional use.

Conclusion. Name any two levels in depth — the safest pair is Reaction and Learning, or Behaviour and Results — then briefly complete the model. Kirkpatrick's four levels together define training effectiveness; two names without explanation cannot earn 8 marks.

Question 53 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Analyse why a training program may receive positive participant reactions but still fail to improve job performance.

Introduction

This is the gap between Kirkpatrick level 1 (reaction) and levels 3–4 (behaviour and results). Participants may honestly enjoy the programme — good food, charming trainer, beautiful venue, easy days away from work — and still work exactly as before on Monday. Analysis must look inside the programme, at the original need, and at the workplace. Do not write only 'they were happy'.

Detailed points

1. Entertainment is not learning. A motivational speaker and a hill-station venue raise reaction. If skill was not practised, level 2 never happened. Job performance cannot improve from quotes in a notebook. Analysis: the programme optimised the wrong level.

2. Learning too easy or too theoretical. Content that does not stretch, or that never leaves the slide, leaves people happy and still incompetent. They liked it because it did not demand uncomfortable practice.

3. Wrong need — TNA was missing. The performance problem was a tool, a process, an impossible target, or a pay issue. Training cannot improve job performance then, however pleasant. Notes: training is not the answer to all problems. Analysis starts at Stage 1 failure.

4. Hostile or empty transfer climate. The boss says ‘forget the classroom, we have targets’. Peers mock the new method. The official SOP is not the real SOP. Behaviour cannot change. Reaction was about the classroom; performance lives in the department.

5. No opportunity to use the skill. The software is not installed, or the task comes once in six months. Skill decays. Reaction was real; performance chance never came.

6. Conflicting appraisal and rewards. Taught quality; paid only for speed. People follow pay. Analysis: organisational systems beat training. Job performance is a system outcome.

7. No follow-up, coaching or IDP. One event, no refreshers, no supervisor observation. Learning decays. Positive reaction is about a memory of a good two days, not about a changed habit.

8. Analytical conclusion for the examiner. Reaction is a weak predictor of job performance because enjoyment, learning, transfer conditions and organisational systems are different things. HRD must design for levels 2–4 and for climate, not for applause. A programme can fail at any step after a successful level 1.

Conclusion. Positive reactions with no performance gain usually mean the programme was pleasant but diagnostically wrong, theoretically thin, or unsupported at work. Analyse classroom, TNA and workplace. Do not confuse smile sheets with HRD effectiveness.

Question 54 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Analyse the consequences of designing a training program without conducting an adequate Training Needs Assessment.

Introduction

Consequence means what happens next, to work, to money, to people, and to HRD itself. Inadequate TNA means the designer did not properly study organisation goals, tasks, persons, and non-training causes. Design then aims at a fog. Analyse a chain of effects, not a single sentence ‘it will fail’.

Detailed points

1. Wrong content — the original problem continues. Topics miss the real KSA gaps. Errors, delays or rude service continue. Staff and customers see no benefit. Operational consequence is ‘we trained and nothing changed’.

2. Wrong audience. Skilled staff are bored (they may even give poor reaction); needy staff are absent. Development equity fails. The people who needed help remain unhelped.

3. Wrong method. A lecture is used where coaching was needed, or a two-day off-site where a one-week OJT would have worked. Learning and transfer fail even if the topic name was roughly right.

4. Training as a false solution — the dangerous consequence. System problems (machine, incentive, staffing) remain. Management thinks ‘we already trained them’ and stops looking. The next time errors occur, workers are blamed personally. This consequence is moral as well as operational.

5. Demotivation and cynicism about HRD. Employees lose faith. Future programmes suffer ‘attendance of the body but not of the mind’. Climate worsens. Later even a good TNA-based course is harder to run.

6. Wasted budget and lost production time. Direct vendor cost plus opportunity cost of people away from work. In a tight organisation this is serious. Mention both costs in the exam.

7. Evaluation becomes theatre. No true objectives or baseline, so anyone can claim success or failure. The training cycle cannot learn. HRD cannot improve.

8. Strategic drift over time. The calendar becomes a ritual disconnected from goals. Capability lag appears in a crisis — quality failure, digital lag. Consequence is long-term organisational weakness, not only one bad course.

Conclusion. Without adequate TNA, design produces wrong content, people and methods; hides real causes; wastes money; creates cynicism; and blocks honest evaluation and strategy. Adequate TNA is professional risk control, not extra paperwork. Analyse this chain in the answer book.

Question 55 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Evaluate the usefulness of the Kirkpatrick model for judging the effectiveness of an organisational training program.

Introduction

Evaluate = usefulness + limitations + how to use it well + a verdict. The Kirkpatrick model judges training at reaction, learning, behaviour and results. The notes already ask HRD to look beyond affective reactions to learning, behaviour and impact on corporate objectives. So the model fits the syllabus. It is not perfect science.

Detailed points

1. Usefulness — completeness compared with smile sheets. It forces attention to learning, job behaviour and organisational results. That matches professional HRD and prevents the entertainment illusion. This is its greatest use.

2. Usefulness — a common language with managers. Four levels are easy to explain to people who fund training. HRD can say: we will not claim success only on tea and venue. Communication value is real in organisations.

3. Usefulness — helps design and diagnosis. If you plan measures at TNA time, objectives become operational. If reaction is high and behaviour is low, look at transfer climate, not only the trainer. The model locates the break in the chain.

4. Limitation — causality at level 4. Sales, quality and profit have many causes. Training may be only one. Over-claiming ‘this course caused 10% profit’ is unscientific. Usefulness falls if the model is treated as proof rather than as a guide.

5. Limitation — cost, time and incomplete use. Behaviour and results need follow-up months later. Many firms stop at level 1; then the model is unused, which is not the model’s fault, but it limits usefulness in practice.

6. Limitation — not every programme needs all four levels equally. A one-hour policy briefing versus a critical safety skill should not consume the same evaluation energy. Usefulness depends on proportionate use.

7. How to use it well. Plan measures early; collect baseline; combine with transfer design (boss support); do not worship level 1; be modest at level 4; use more depth for costly or high-risk training.

8. Verdict. The Kirkpatrick model is highly useful as a guiding framework for judging organisational training effectiveness, especially compared with judging only participant happiness. It is not a mechanical proof of success. Recommend it with judgement, not as four forms to file and forget.

***Conclusion.** Useful for completeness, communication, design and diagnosis; limited on causality, cost and one-size use. Verdict: keep Kirkpatrick as the standard HRD map of effectiveness, apply it proportionately and honestly.*

Question 56 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Analyse how the choice among on-the-job, off-the-job, and e-learning methods can affect training outcomes.

Introduction

Outcomes mean what happens at Kirkpatrick's levels — did they like it, learn, change behaviour, and improve results? Method is not a decoration. On-the-job, off-the-job and e-learning create different kinds of learning experiences, different costs, and different transfer patterns. Analysis should take each method, then discuss fit, blending, and climate.

Detailed points

1. On-the-job outcomes. Typically strong relevance and transfer (good path to level 3) if the coach is skilled and has time. Outcomes become bad if the coach is busy or teaches shortcuts: then the organisation mass-produces wrong methods. OJT can also injure on dangerous tasks. Outcome quality follows coach quality more than the label 'OJT'.

2. Off-the-job outcomes. Typically better conceptual learning and safer practice (stronger level 2 for new or risky skills). Level 3 suffers if the classroom does not resemble work or if bosses do not continue coaching. Cost and time away from work can be high; if TNA was weak, outcomes are expensive irrelevance with possibly high reaction (nice venue).

3. E-learning outcomes. Good for consistent knowledge, scale, tracking (level 2 for information; level 1 depends on design quality). Weak completion if self-discipline or connectivity is poor. Weak for complex interpersonal skill unless blended with role play. Outcome risk: organisations think 'we have an LMS so people are trained' while completion and transfer are low.

4. Fit to objective changes outcomes more than fashion. Motor skill → OJT or simulation. Interpersonal skill → role play then OJT. Information update → e-learning. Wrong fit lowers outcomes regardless of budget. Analysis: choose method from TNA, not from what is trendy.

5. Learner and context factors. New employees often need structured off-the-job. Experienced staff may prefer OJT or micro e-learning. Scattered locations favour e-learning. Mismatch reduces motivation and therefore learning outcomes.

6. Blended outcomes are often superior. Concept via e-learning or class, practice off-the-job, application on-the-job with a coach. Each method covers another's weakness. Analysis: the choice is frequently 'how to combine', not 'which one winner'.

7. Climate can cancel any method. If the workplace punishes new behaviour, OJT, classroom and e-learning all fail at level 3. Method analysis without transfer climate is incomplete.

8. Analytical close. Outcomes are produced by fit + quality of execution + transfer support, not by the brand name of the method. Method choice is a strategic HRD decision because it shapes whether learning stays in the head or appears in job performance.

Conclusion. OJT favours transfer but depends on coaches; off-the-job favours safe conceptual and skill practice but risks transfer failure; e-learning favours scale and knowledge consistency but risks low completion and weak people-skills. Fit, blending and climate decide outcomes. Write this analysis, not three disconnected definitions.

Question 57 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

State any two reasons for evaluating training at more than one Kirkpatrick level.

Introduction

One level, especially reaction only, cannot tell whether training was effective. For 8 marks, two reasons in depth, then supporting reasons. The two strongest: different levels answer different questions; and several levels are needed to diagnose where the chain broke.

Detailed points

- 1. First reason — different levels answer different questions.** Reaction asks ‘did they like it?’ Learning asks ‘did they get the KSA?’ Behaviour asks ‘do they do it at work?’ Results ask ‘did the organisation benefit?’ Liking is not learning; learning is not doing; doing is not always business results. Evaluating at only one level answers only one of these questions and then pretends it answered all. That is why more than one level is needed.
- 2. Example for the first reason.** A fire-safety course can be popular (level 1) while people still cannot use an extinguisher (level 2). Or they can pass a test (level 2) and still not follow procedure on the shop floor (level 3). One number cannot stand for effectiveness.
- 3. Second reason — diagnosis of failure so HRD can improve.** If you only know that ‘performance did not improve’, you do not know whether to change content, trainer, transfer climate, or the original diagnosis. Multi-level data show the break. High reaction + low learning → redesign method. High learning + low behaviour → fix bosses and job conditions. This diagnostic purpose is why the cycle includes evaluation.
- 4. Accountability reason.** Organisations fund training for performance, not for entertainment. More than one level is needed to be honest with those who paid in money and lost work time.
- 5. Avoiding false positives and false negatives.** High reaction can hide zero performance change (false success). Low reaction (strict trainer, hard practice) might still mean high learning (false failure if you only measure smiles). Multiple levels protect employees and HRD from both errors.
- 6. Employee development reason.** Learning and behaviour data guide further coaching of the same people. Evaluation is feedback to the learner, not only a report to the board.
- 7. Strategic HRD reason.** Only higher levels show contribution to organisational goals. If HRD wants strategic status, it cannot live on level 1.
- 8. Exam wrap.** Two reasons as long paragraphs with examples, then accountability, false success/failure, learner feedback, strategy. Conclusion: multi-level evaluation is how HRD tells the truth.

Conclusion. Two main reasons: (1) each Kirkpatrick level answers a different question, so one level cannot define effectiveness; (2) several levels are needed to diagnose where training failed so that HRD can improve. Add accountability and avoiding smile-sheet illusions. Evaluating at more than one level is a professional necessity.

Question 58 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Mention any two factors that should be considered while selecting a training method.

Introduction

Selecting a method means choosing OJT, lecture, case, role play, vestibule, simulation, e-learning, outdoor training, and so on — or a blend. Two headline factors for 8 marks: the learning objectives, and the nature of the task. Then list other factors (trainees, cost, location, culture) so the answer is complete.

Detailed points

- 1. First factor — learning objectives.** What must the person be able to do after training? Knowledge, skill and attitude need different methods. You cannot lecture people into a motor skill. You cannot only give an e-module and expect counselling skill. You cannot only do a game if they must memorise a legal checklist. Objectives, written in observable language from TNA, are the first selector of method.
- 2. Example.** Objective ‘explain three causes of defects’ can use discussion and quiz. Objective ‘replace a filter in eight minutes without leaks’ needs demonstration, simulation and OJT. Same department, different methods.
- 3. Second factor — nature of the job or task.** Dangerous or costly tasks need simulation or vestibule before live OJT (safety, aircraft, surgery, high-voltage). Simple routine skills already done well by seniors may use OJT. Customer-facing tasks need practice with feedback (role play). If the workplace currently teaches the wrong method, off-the-job is needed first so that bad habits are not copied.
- 4. Trainee characteristics.** Education, language, digital literacy, experience, motivation, number of people. Illiterate workers need demonstration, not dense e-text. Thousands of scattered staff favour e-learning for knowledge parts.
- 5. Cost, time and production loss.** Can the organisation spare people for five days off-site? Is the budget enough for a simulator? Method choice is also resource choice. Cheap methods that fail are not actually cheap.
- 6. Geography, facilities and trainer availability.** No lab means you cannot choose vestibule. No internal expert may mean a vendor or e-module. Distant plants change the choice toward e-learning plus local OJT coaches.
- 7. Transfer requirements and urgency.** If the skill must appear tomorrow on the job, OJT with a coach and a job aid may beat a delayed residential course. If the skill is rare, off-the-job practice may be safer.
- 8. Organisational culture and climate.** Will role play or open discussion be accepted, or seen as loss of face? Culture-blind method choice fails even if theoretically correct. Climate also decides whether any method will transfer.

Conclusion. Two main factors in selecting a training method are (1) the learning objectives (knowledge/skill/attitude) and (2) the nature of the task (danger, complexity, whether the workplace already models the right way). Also consider trainees, cost, location, urgency and culture. Method selection must be systematic, from TNA, not from habit.

Question 59 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Design a complete training program for a clearly identified employee skill gap, covering TNA, objectives, training method, delivery, and evaluation.

Introduction

A complete design must name a real skill gap and then walk through all four stages of the training cycle plus transfer. Use a concrete example so the examiner sees a programme, not a theory dump. Example used here: customer-service staff in a service organisation have a skill gap in handling complaints — repeat complaints are high and first-contact resolution is low. You may use another gap (machine setup, safety lock-out, classroom questioning skill) if you

prefer, but you must cover TNA, objectives, method, delivery and evaluation.

Detailed points

1. **TNA.** Organisation: customer-retention strategy; complaints hurt repeat business. Task: listen without interrupting, log in CRM, offer SOP solution, escalate correctly, close respectfully. Person: who fails — mostly staff with less than one year? Can they recite the SOP (knowledge) but freeze on angry customers (skill/attitude)? Check non-training causes: if the CRM is down or refund policy is unclear, fix that first. Collect baseline: repeat-complaint percentage and customer satisfaction score.
2. **Objectives (observable).** By end of classroom: given a recorded angry complaint, the trainee will listen, log all mandatory fields, and choose the correct SOP action or escalation in a role play scoring at least 80% on a checklist. Within eight weeks on the job: repeat complaints for trained staff fall by an agreed percentage versus baseline. Write both learning and performance objectives.
3. **Training method — blend.** E-module on policy and CRM screens (concept). Classroom role play with recorded calls and peer-plus-trainer feedback (skill and attitude). Then two weeks of on-the-job coaching with a checklist (transfer). This blend matches both knowledge and practical skill.
4. **Delivery.** Batches of about 12 so that everyone practises, not 60 people watching a lecture. Facilitator skilled in role play. Working CRM training logins. Quiet room. Manager present at the close to commit support. Admin: handouts of SOP, water, time-table that protects practice hours. Each trainee writes an action plan for Monday.
5. **Transfer support (part of a complete design).** Supervisor weekly coaching for a month; a job aid near the phone; appraisal KRA includes resolution quality, not only number of calls. Without this, the design is not complete even if the class was excellent.
6. **Evaluation levels 1 and 2.** Reaction form with relevance items. Knowledge test on SOP. Observed role-play score versus checklist (learning of skill).
7. **Evaluation levels 3 and 4.** Call audits at 30 and 60 days (behaviour). Repeat-complaint rate and CSAT versus baseline (results). If possible, compare trained group with a not-yet-trained group. Meet HRD and department head at 60 days to refine SOP or coaching.
8. **Why this counts as complete.** All four cycle stages are present, the gap is specified, methods match objectives, delivery is practical, transfer is designed, evaluation uses more than smile sheets. That is what the question asked you to design.

Conclusion. *Present one clear skill gap and a full cycle: TNA (including non-training checks and baseline), observable objectives, blended methods, careful delivery, transfer support, and multi-level evaluation. A complete programme is a process, not a one-day event with a banner.*

Question 60 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Evaluate two alternative training programs for the same organisational need using the Kirkpatrick model and recommend the more effective program.

Introduction

Evaluation using Kirkpatrick means judging each alternative at reaction, learning, behaviour and results, then recommending. Need used here: first-line supervisors must learn to give developmental feedback (this supports HRD climate and appraisal as a development tool). Programme A is glamorous but shallow. Programme B is TNA-based and blended. You may change the need, but you must compare two programmes level by level and give a clear recommendation.

Detailed points

1. Programme A described. Two-day off-site ‘leadership’ with a famous motivational speaker, luxury venue, little practice of feedback skill, no involvement of the supervisors’ own bosses, no follow-up, no change in appraisal forms. Marketing looks excellent.

2. Programme B described. Built from TNA: short concept module on what developmental feedback is; extensive role play with checklists; real feedback assignments on the job; the supervisors’ bosses act as coaches; 60-day follow-up workshop; an appraisal item on coaching quality. Venue is ordinary.

3. Level 1 — Reaction. A will often score higher: travel, celebrity, food. B will score adequately if participants see job relevance, but some may say it was ‘hard work’. If the organisation judged only level 1, it would wrongly buy A.

4. Level 2 — Learning. B is superior because people practise the actual skill and get feedback. A may give memorable quotes without the ability to hold a feedback conversation. Tests and role-play scores would show this if anyone measured them.

5. Level 3 — Behaviour. B is far superior: assignments, job aids, and boss support. A rarely transfers; the old habit of only scolding or only silence returns. Climate of the supervisors’ own workplace decides A’s failure.

6. Level 4 — Results. B is more likely to improve employee development climate, earlier correction of errors, and engagement in the supervisors’ teams. A is costly with little organisational result. Level 4 is why the company should care.

7. Recommendation. Recommend Programme B even if smile sheets are slightly lower. Effectiveness in HRD is behaviour and results in the service of the organisational need, not applause. State the condition: B still fails at level 3 if top management does not support coaching time — so the recommendation includes that support.

8. What this evaluation teaches. Kirkpatrick protects the organisation from buying the more popular but less effective programme. Write this meta-point; it shows you can use the model, not only recite it.

Conclusion. Compare A and B at all four Kirkpatrick levels. Recommend the TNA-based blended Programme B because it can reach learning, behaviour and results, while A mainly maximises reaction. Effectiveness is not the same as popularity. Condition: workplace support must accompany B.